

HISTORY HACK™

TEACHER ANSWER KEY

U.S. History

Document-Based Question Workbook

Exemplar Responses & Scoring Rubrics

The Complete Collection · Units 1–10 · Standards US.01–US.95

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This volume contains model answers and scoring guidance for every document-based question in the U.S. History DBQ Workbook. Keep it secure; it is intended for the instructor only.

How to Use This Answer Key

For every unit, this key mirrors the student packet document-by-document and provides two things: **exemplars** (model responses) and **rubrics** (scoring guidance). It is organized to be read side-by-side with the matching Primary Source Packet and DBQ Worksheets.

WHAT YOU'LL FIND FOR EACH UNIT

- **Document Exemplars (1–14)** — for every source, a model *Analyze* answer (the main question) and a model *Extend* answer (the higher-order sourcing/HIPPO question). Each names what a strong response does, not just the “right” fact.
- **Model HIPPO** — two documents fully sourced across all five lenses (Historical context, Intended audience, Purpose, Point of view, Outside information) as worked examples of complete sourcing.
- **Model CER Essay** — a full Claim–Evidence–Reasoning response to the unit DBQ, written to the top of the rubric, with sourcing and a complexity paragraph.
- **Scoring Rubric** — point-by-point guidance for the 6-point DBQ, with what earns and what does *not* earn each point.

THE 6-POINT DBQ RUBRIC AT A GLANCE

Claim / Thesis — 1 pt

Evidence from Documents — 2 pts

Reasoning — 1 pt

Sourcing (HIPPO) — 1 pt

Complexity — 1 pt

Total — 6 pts

Model answers are guidance, not the only acceptable responses. Accept any answer that is text-based, accurate, and reasoned; student wording will vary widely. The exemplars show the *ceiling* and the reasoning behaviors to look for — reward evidence and reasoning, not matching phrasing.

TWO NOTES BEFORE HIGH-STAKES USE

Confidentiality. This key is for the instructor. Do not post it to a shared drive or LMS, distribute it to students, or include it in the student workbook.

Sources. A dagger (†) in the packet marks a reconstructed or specially-handled excerpt (see the “Note on Sources”). The exemplars assume each excerpt says what the historical record says; before using any item on a graded assessment, confirm the source text against the citation provided.

U.S. HISTORY HACK™

BY TROOPTOEACHER

UNIT 1



The Rise of Industrialization

1877–1900 • US.01–US.07

TROOPTOEACHER TECHNOLOGIES LLC

DBQ Answer Key & Scoring Guide

Rise of Industrialization (1877–1900)
Standards US.01 – US.07

Teacher-facing document. Model answers are strong exemplars to guide scoring — not the only acceptable responses. Accept any answer that is accurate and well-supported by the documents.

Document Answer Notes

DOC 1 Homestead Act

US.01

ANALYZE

According to the Homestead Act, who was eligible to claim public land — and what conditions did they have to meet?

✓ Adult U.S. citizens — or immigrants who had filed a declaration of intent to naturalize — including women (“head of a family”), could claim up to a quarter section (160 acres), but only by swearing the claim was for their own actual settlement and cultivation, not for anyone else.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The act required claimants to swear the land was for their own “actual settlement.” What problem in earlier land policy was this rule likely written to prevent?

✓ Earlier land policy had been exploited by speculators who seized public land to resell at a profit. The required affidavit of “actual settlement” was meant to block speculation and put land in the hands of genuine farmers.

DOC 2 Pacific Railway Act

US.01

ANALYZE

What does this excerpt reveal about federal policy toward Native Americans during railroad construction?

✓ It shows the federal government treated Native land as an obstacle to development: it promised to “extinguish as rapidly as may be” Native land titles along the route so the railroad and its land grants could proceed.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The same government that gave land to settlers (Doc 1) and railroads (Doc 2) first had to “extinguish... the Indian titles.” Whose interests did federal land policy serve, and at whose expense?

✓ Federal land policy served white settlers and railroad corporations; the cost fell on Native nations, whose land was cleared to enable both the homesteads (Doc 1) and the railroads (Doc 2).

DOC 3 Dawes General Allotment Act**US.02****ANALYZE**

What was the main purpose of the Dawes Act based on this excerpt — and what did it do to tribal landholding?

✓ Its purpose was to break up communally held reservations into individual family plots (“severalty”), held in trust for 25 years. It weakened collective tribal ownership and opened “surplus” land to white settlement.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The word “severalty” means individual, not collective, ownership. How did replacing tribal ownership with individual plots serve the government’s larger goals?

✓ Replacing collective ownership with individual plots undercut tribal cohesion, advanced forced assimilation, and made it easier to transfer millions of “surplus” acres to white settlers.

DOC 4 Rules for Indian Schools**US.02****ANALYZE**

What does this document reveal about the goals of Indian boarding schools?

✓ Forced assimilation: erase Native languages and “tribal customs” and replace them with English and Anglo-American habits, enforced through punishment.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

This is an official rulebook — written to be followed, not published to persuade. How does that purpose make its blunt statements about “tribal customs” especially revealing to a historian?

✓ Because it is an internal rulebook meant to be obeyed rather than to persuade the public, its blunt language about abandoning “tribal customs” openly states the assimilation aim that public statements often softened.

DOC 5 Plessy v. Ferguson**US.03****ANALYZE**

What argument did the Supreme Court make to justify segregation in Plessy v. Ferguson?

✓ The Court argued that separation did not itself brand Black Americans as inferior, and that any sense of inferiority was the “construction” the Black community chose to put on the law — not the law’s doing.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Justice Harlan’s lone dissent called the Constitution “color-blind.” What assumption in the majority’s reasoning was he attacking — and why has history sided with him?

✓ Justice Harlan attacked the majority’s assumption that the law could be neutral about segregation. History has sided with his “color-blind Constitution” dissent: Plessy licensed decades of Jim Crow until Brown v. Board (1954).

DOC 6 Benjamin “Pap” Singleton Testimony**US.03****ANALYZE**

According to Singleton, what motivated him to organize African American migration to Kansas?

✓ The lack of land, poverty, and worsening conditions for Black Southerners after Reconstruction (“coming down instead of going up”) drove Singleton to organize migration to Kansas.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Compare Singleton’s testimony with the Court in Plessy (Doc 5). How is leaving the South its own form of resistance to Jim Crow?

✓ Leaving the South (the Exoduster migration) was itself resistance to Jim Crow: rather than accept the segregation upheld in Plessy (Doc 5), tens of thousands sought land and safety elsewhere.

DOC 7 Pendleton Civil Service Reform Act**US.04****ANALYZE**

What problem was the Pendleton Act designed to address?

✓ The spoils system — jobs handed out as political rewards and workers pressured for donations/service. The act required competitive exams and barred coercion of government employees.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Read this next to Bryce’s description of the “Boss” (Doc 14). How does the exam requirement directly attack the machine’s source of power?

✓ Hiring by merit exam cut off the machine’s supply of patronage jobs — the very favors the boss (Doc 14) traded for loyalty and votes — striking at the machine’s source of power.

DOC 8 The Gospel of Wealth**US.05****ANALYZE**

According to Carnegie, what responsibility did wealthy individuals have?

✓ The wealthy had a duty to live modestly, provide for their families, and then administer all surplus wealth as “trustees” for the public good during their own lifetimes.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Carnegie was himself one of the wealthiest industrialists in America. How might his point of view shape this argument — and who stays in control of the wealth in his vision?

✓ As one of the richest industrialists in America, Carnegie’s argument justified great fortunes and kept control of the wealth with the rich, who supposedly knew better than the poor how to spend it — a paternalistic view.

DOC 9 Madam C.J. Walker, Address to the N.N.B.L.

US.05

ANALYZE

What does Walker’s account reveal about how she defined her own success?

✓ Walker defined success as self-made achievement (cotton field → washtub → factory owner) and as creating employment and independence for other Black women, not merely personal wealth.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Place Walker beside Carnegie (Doc 8). Both are wealthy entrepreneurs — but how do their ideas about the purpose of their wealth differ, and how might their very different life stories explain that?

✓ Unlike Carnegie (Doc 8), whose wealth flowed downward as charity from above, Walker’s rose from the bottom, and she measured it by the opportunity it gave others of her race — a contrast rooted in their very different life stories.

DOC 10 How the Other Half Lives

US.06

ANALYZE

How does Jacob Riis characterize living conditions in tenements?

✓ As breeding grounds of disease, crime, and poverty that endanger the whole city and, worst of all, corrupt family life.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Riis wanted to shock middle-class readers into reform. How might that purpose shape his word choices (“hot-beds,” “human wrecks,” “moral contagion”) — and does persuasion make a source less reliable, or just reveal its point of view?

✓ His purpose was to shock middle-class readers into reform, so he used vivid, alarming language. That persuasive intent reveals his point of view but does not make his depiction of real tenement conditions unreliable.

DOC 11 Italian Immigrant Folk Saying

US.06

ANALYZE

What does this folk saying reveal about the immigrant experience in America?

✓ That the promise of easy opportunity (“streets paved with gold”) was a myth: immigrants found hard, low-paid labor and were the ones expected to build America.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

A law (like Doc 12) has a clear author and date; this saying does not. What can a historian still learn from an anonymous folk saying — and what must they be careful about?

✓ A historian can learn a group’s shared memory and sentiment from an anonymous saying, but cannot treat it as a specific, verifiable fact from a known author — it captures mood, not documented events.

DOC 12 Chinese Exclusion Act**US.07****ANALYZE**

What was the stated justification for the Chinese Exclusion Act?

- ✓ The stated justification was that the arrival of Chinese laborers “endangers the good order of certain localities.”

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The law states its reason in its own preamble (“endangers the good order”). How is a law’s stated purpose different from its real purpose — and what outside evidence would you need to tell them apart?

- ✓ The law’s stated purpose (public order) differs from its real cause (anti-Chinese racism and labor competition, especially in the West). Outside evidence about nativism of the era is needed to tell them apart.

DOC 13 Twenty Years at Hull-House**US.07****ANALYZE**

According to Jane Addams, what was the philosophy behind Hull-House?

- ✓ That the classes depend on one another reciprocally, so educated reformers should live among and serve their poor immigrant neighbors.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The Chinese Exclusion Act (Doc 12) and Hull-House (Doc 13) are two American responses to immigration in the same era. What do they reveal about the nation’s divided attitudes toward newcomers?

- ✓ The Chinese Exclusion Act (Doc 12) shut immigrants out, while Hull-House welcomed and served them — together revealing the era’s divided attitudes toward newcomers.

DOC 14 Bryce on the Political “Boss”**US.04****ANALYZE**

How does Bryce’s description of the political “Boss” help explain why the Pendleton Civil Service Reform Act (Doc 7) was needed?

- ✓ The boss sought power for its own sake, because power meant control of offices, contracts, and public money — not the welfare of the public.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Bryce was a British outsider studying American democracy. How might that distance make his analysis sharper — and where might it make him miss things an insider would know?

- ✓ As a British outsider, Bryce could analyze the machine’s workings bluntly; but he might miss the neighborhood loyalty and services that made machines genuinely popular with immigrant voters.

Model HIPPO Source Analysis

Worked examples for two documents. Use to model sourcing for students.

Doc 8 — The Gospel of Wealth (Andrew Carnegie, 1889)

H — Historical Context	Written at the height of the Gilded Age, when a few industrialists held enormous fortunes and critics attacked the growing gap between rich and poor.
I — Intended Audience	Educated, well-off readers of the North American Review — and fellow men of wealth.
P — Purpose	To justify large fortunes and persuade the wealthy to give money away during their lifetimes rather than face calls to redistribute it.
P — Point of View	Carnegie was himself one of the richest men in America; he had a personal stake in defending how such wealth was made and controlled.
O — Outside Information	Connects to Standard Oil, trusts, and the era’s debates over regulation and philanthropy.

Doc 5 — Plessy v. Ferguson (1896)

H — Historical Context	Decided as Southern states were building the Jim Crow system after Reconstruction collapsed.
I — Intended Audience	The nation’s courts, lawmakers, and public — it set binding legal precedent.
P — Purpose	To rule on whether “separate but equal” railcar laws violated the 14th Amendment; the majority upheld them.
P — Point of View	The majority reflected the racial assumptions of white authorities of the era; Harlan’s lone dissent rejected them.
O — Outside Information	Connects to the 14th Amendment, Jim Crow laws, and the later Brown v. Board (1954) reversal.

Model DBQ Response (CER)

THE QUESTION

Between 1877 and 1900, the United States expanded westward and industrialized at an extraordinary pace. Using the documents in this packet, evaluate the extent to which this era of growth expanded opportunity for some groups of Americans while denying it to others.

CLAIM: Between 1877 and 1900, the nation’s growth expanded opportunity dramatically for white settlers and industrialists while denying it to Native Americans, Black Americans, and many immigrants — so the era’s “progress” was real but deeply unequal.

Evidence & Reasoning (expanded opportunity): The Homestead Act (Doc 1) opened 160-acre farms to citizens and future citizens, and the Pacific Railway Act (Doc 2) handed railroads vast land grants — together fueling western settlement and industry. Carnegie’s Gospel of Wealth (Doc 8) and Madam C.J. Walker’s rise (Doc 9) show fortunes being built, Walker’s even creating opportunity for other Black women.

Evidence & Reasoning (opportunity denied): That same growth ran on dispossession and exclusion. The Pacific Railway Act (Doc 2) and Dawes Act (Doc 3) stripped Native nations of land, while boarding-school rules (Doc 4) tried to erase Native culture. Plessy v. Ferguson (Doc 5) locked in segregation, pushing people like Singleton’s followers (Doc 6) to flee the South, and the Chinese Exclusion Act (Doc 12) barred an entire nationality.

SOURCING: Carnegie (Doc 8), a wealthy industrialist, wrote to justify fortunes — his point of view reveals whose interests the era served. The boarding-school rulebook (Doc 4), an internal document, bluntly states an assimilation goal that public statements hid.

COMPLEXITY: The period cannot be judged only as progress or only as oppression — the very policies that expanded opportunity for some (land, railroads, industry) were the ones that denied it to others, making inequality the engine of the era’s growth, not an accident of it.

Rubric & Scoring Guidance

Criterion	What earns the points
Claim / Thesis (1)	Award the point for a defensible claim that takes a position on the extent of opportunity vs. denial and previews a line of reasoning. A restated prompt or a vague “there were good and bad things” does not earn it.
Evidence from documents (2)	2 pts: specific, accurate evidence from four or more documents. 1 pt: evidence from two–three. Evidence must be used to support the claim, not merely listed.
Reasoning (1)	Award when the student explains how a document supports the claim (e.g., why the Dawes Act counts as “denied opportunity”), not just what it says.
Sourcing / HIPPO (1)	Award when, for at least two documents, the student explains how point of view, purpose, situation, or audience matters — e.g., Carnegie’s stake as a rich man, or the rulebook’s internal purpose.
Complexity (1)	Award for genuinely weighing both sides or showing the tension — ideally recognizing that the same growth both expanded and denied opportunity. A one-sided answer does not earn it.

U.S. HISTORY HACK™
— by TroopToTeacher —

UNIT 2



The Progressive Era

1890-1920 • US.08-US.18

DBQ Answer Key & Scoring Guide

Teacher-facing document. Model answers are strong exemplars to guide scoring — not the only acceptable responses. Accept any answer that is accurate and well-supported by the documents.

Document Answer Notes

DOC 1 The History of the Standard Oil Company

US.08

ANALYZE

According to Tarbell, how did Standard Oil gain its power — and why did she see this as a public problem?

✓ Standard Oil gained power through unfair, secretive practices (“loaded dice”) — rebates, pressure, and deals that competitors could not match — rather than honest competition. Tarbell saw this as a public problem because business that affects everyone should be a “public trust.”

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Tarbell was a journalist writing to persuade readers, not a court issuing a verdict. How might that purpose shape her language (“loaded dice,” “public trust”) — and does it make her account less reliable, or just reveal her point of view?

✓ As a muckraking journalist writing to persuade, Tarbell’s charged language (“loaded dice,” “public trust”) reveals her reform purpose and point of view. It marks her as a committed critic but does not by itself make her factual claims false.

DOC 2 The Jungle

US.09

ANALYZE

What conditions does Sinclair describe, and why would this passage alarm ordinary consumers?

✓ Filthy, rat-infested packing rooms where spoiled meat, poison, and dead rats were ground together. It alarmed consumers because this was the very food they were buying and eating.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Sinclair later said, “I aimed at the public’s heart, and by accident I hit it in the stomach.” How does the reaction to this passage show the difference between an author’s purpose and a source’s actual effect?

✓ Sinclair aimed to expose worker exploitation, but the public reacted to food safety — showing that a source’s actual effect can diverge from the author’s purpose. That reaction helped drive the Pure Food and Drug Act (Doc 4).

DOC 3 The Shame of the Cities**US.08****ANALYZE**

Why does Steffens blame ordinary citizens, not just political bosses, for urban corruption?

✓ He blames ordinary citizens' apathy and their focus on business over civic duty; the boss, he says, is "the product of a freed people that have not the spirit to be free."

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Steffens says the "boss" is an American institution produced by a people "that have not the spirit to be free." If the problem is public apathy, what kind of reforms would actually solve it?

✓ If public apathy is the cause, real fixes require civic engagement plus structural reforms (secret ballot, direct primaries, commission government) that loosen the machine's grip and pull citizens back into politics.

DOC 4 Pure Food and Drug Act**US.09****ANALYZE**

What problem was the Pure Food and Drug Act designed to fix, and how does it expand the federal government's role?

✓ To stop the manufacture and sale of contaminated ("adulterated") and falsely labeled ("misbranded") food and drugs. It expands the federal government's power to regulate goods in interstate commerce.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

This law responds directly to muckraking (Docs 1–2). What does that connection reveal about how Progressive reform actually happened — from exposure to legislation?

✓ It followed directly from muckraking (Docs 1–2), illustrating the Progressive pattern: exposure → public outcry → federal legislation.

DOC 5 The Man with the Muck-Rake**US.10****ANALYZE**

How does Roosevelt both praise and criticize the muckrakers in this speech?

✓ He praises muckrakers as often "indispensable" for exposing wrongdoing but warns that if they rake only muck and see nothing good, they lose their usefulness and begin to do harm.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Roosevelt was the president reformers were pressuring. How might his position explain why he wanted to both encourage exposure and set limits on it?

✓ As the president reformers were pressuring, Roosevelt wanted reform's benefits without letting exposure curdle into reckless attacks on all institutions — so he both encouraged and restrained the muckrakers.

DOC 6 Eyewitness to the Triangle Shirtwaist Fire**US.11****ANALYZE****What does this eyewitness account reveal about factory conditions for workers in 1911?**

✓ Deadly conditions: locked exit doors and no escape meant workers — mostly young immigrant women — were trapped and jumped or burned. Worker safety had been sacrificed to control the workforce.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

This is a reporter's emotional first-person account, not an official report. What does that point of view capture that a government statistic could not — and what might it leave out?

✓ As a reporter's emotional eyewitness account, it conveys human horror and specific detail (the "door must be kept locked" sign) that a statistic cannot — but it is one vantage point, not a full official investigation.

DOC 7 Muller v. Oregon**US.11****ANALYZE**

How did the Court justify limiting women's working hours — and what assumption about women underlies its reasoning?

✓ The Court upheld limiting women's working hours by reasoning that women's health and their role as mothers made them a special class in need of protection.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

This decision protected women workers yet rested on the idea that women were weaker and defined by motherhood. How can a "reform" both help a group and reinforce inequality?

✓ The ruling helped women workers yet rested on the belief that women were weaker and defined by motherhood — a "reform" that simultaneously protected women and reinforced their unequal, limited status.

DOC 8 Address on Child Labor**US.12****ANALYZE**

How does Kelley connect the fight against child labor to women's right to vote?

✓ She links child labor to suffrage: if mothers could vote, she argues, no legislature would dare pass a law letting fourteen-year-old girls work all night.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Kelley is a reformer speaking to persuade an audience. How does she use specific numbers and vivid images ("while we sleep") to move listeners toward two causes at once?

✓ As a reformer persuading an audience, Kelley uses concrete numbers (two million working children) and vivid images ("while we sleep") to move listeners toward two causes at once — ending child labor and winning the vote for women.

DOC 9 The Atlanta Exposition Address**US.13****ANALYZE**

What approach to racial progress does Washington urge — and what is he willing to accept to get it?

✓ Economic self-help and vocational skill, staying in the South, and accepting social separation (“separate as the fingers”) for the time being in exchange for white cooperation and gradual progress.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Washington spoke to a white Southern audience whose support he needed. How might that audience explain the compromises in his message — and set up Du Bois’s response (Doc 10)?

✓ Speaking to a white Southern audience whose goodwill he needed, Washington framed a compromise meant to reassure them — which helps explain its accommodating tone and sets up Du Bois’s rejection (Doc 10).

DOC 10 The Souls of Black Folk**US.13****ANALYZE**

How does Du Bois’s vision for African American progress differ from Washington’s (Doc 9)?

✓ Du Bois agrees on thrift and education but refuses to surrender the vote, civil rights, or higher education; he demands full rights now, “by every civilized and peaceful method.”

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Read Docs 9 and 10 together. These two leaders shared a goal but split on method. What does their disagreement reveal about the hard choices facing Black Americans under Jim Crow?

✓ Docs 9 and 10 share the goal of Black advancement but split on method — accommodation vs. protest — revealing the hard strategic choices under Jim Crow. Du Bois’s stance helped shape the NAACP.

DOC 11 Niagara Movement Declaration of Principles**US.13****ANALYZE**

What demands does the Niagara Movement make, and how do they reflect Du Bois’s approach rather than Washington’s?

✓ Full manhood suffrage now, an end to segregation in public accommodations, enforcement of the Constitution, and full education — immediate, uncompromising demands that reflect Du Bois’s approach rather than Washington’s.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

This is a group manifesto meant to rally support. How does its language (“we want... and we want it now”) work differently from a court ruling or a law?

✓ As a group manifesto meant to rally supporters, its repeated “we want... and we want it now” works as a rallying cry — a different rhetorical job than the measured language of a law or a court ruling.

DOC 12 Address to Congress on Woman Suffrage

US.14

ANALYZE

How does Catt use America's own history and ideals to argue for women's right to vote?

✓ She argues suffrage is “inevitable” because America was born of a revolution for self-government, and the nation's own logic requires extending the vote to its “last unenfranchised class.”

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Catt appeals to patriotism and national logic rather than only fairness to women. Why might that argument be especially persuasive to the Congress she is addressing?

✓ Appealing to patriotism and national logic — not only fairness to women — is especially persuasive to Congress, because it frames suffrage as the fulfillment of America's founding principles rather than a radical demand.

DOC 13 The Nineteenth Amendment

US.14

ANALYZE

What did the Nineteenth Amendment guarantee — and why is it considered a major Progressive achievement?

✓ It guaranteed that the right to vote could not be denied “on account of sex,” securing woman suffrage nationwide — a landmark Progressive constitutional achievement.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The amendment bans denying the vote “on account of sex,” but many Black women in the South still could not vote after 1920. How can a reform be a real victory and still leave people behind?

✓ It was a real victory, yet many Black women — especially in the South — were still blocked by poll taxes, literacy tests, and violence. A reform can expand democracy and still leave whole groups behind.

DOC 14 The New Nationalism

US.10

ANALYZE

What kind of government does Roosevelt's “New Nationalism” call for, and why?

✓ A strong, active national government — with the president as “steward of the public welfare” — that regulates big business in the public interest.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Roosevelt wanted a stronger federal government to check big business. Connect this to the regulation in Doc 4 — how does “New Nationalism” sum up the Progressive answer to industrialization?

✓ It generalizes the Progressive answer to industrialization: where Doc 4 regulates specific goods, New Nationalism states the broad principle that the federal government should actively check corporate power for the common good.

Model HIPPO Source Analysis

Worked examples for two documents. Use to model sourcing for students.

Doc 1 — The History of the Standard Oil Company (Ida Tarbell, 1904)

H — Historical Context	Published during the muckraking era, when magazines exposed the abuses of the great trusts that dominated the economy.
I — Intended Audience	The wide middle-class readership of McClure's Magazine — voters and consumers.
P — Purpose	To expose Standard Oil's unfair practices and build public pressure for regulating monopolies.
P — Point of View	Tarbell was a crusading journalist (whose own father had been ruined by Standard Oil) — a committed critic, not a neutral observer.
O — Outside Information	Connects to the Sherman Antitrust Act and the eventual 1911 breakup of Standard Oil.

Doc 9 — The Atlanta Exposition Address (Booker T. Washington, 1895)

H — Historical Context	Delivered as Southern states were entrenching segregation and disfranchisement after Reconstruction.
I — Intended Audience	A mostly white Southern audience whose cooperation and investment Washington was seeking.
P — Purpose	To reassure white Southerners and win support for Black economic advancement by promising patience and social separation.
P — Point of View	Washington led a vocational institute dependent on white goodwill and funding — a stake that shaped his accommodating message.
O — Outside Information	Connects to Du Bois's rebuttal (Doc 10), the Niagara Movement (Doc 11), and the founding of the NAACP.

Model DBQ Response (CER)

THE QUESTION

Progressive reformers between 1890 and 1920 set out to fix the problems created by industrialization. Using the documents in this packet, evaluate the extent to which Progressive Era reforms made American society more democratic and just.

CLAIM: Progressive reforms made American society meaningfully more democratic and just — through consumer protection, labor law, and the vote — but the gains were uneven and largely bypassed Black Americans, so the era expanded justice without delivering it equally.

Evidence & Reasoning (successes): After muckrakers exposed abuses (Tarbell, Doc 1; Sinclair, Doc 2), the Pure Food and Drug Act (Doc 4) gave the federal government power to protect consumers. *Muller v. Oregon* (Doc 7) upheld limits on working hours, the Nineteenth Amendment (Doc 13) enfranchised women, and Roosevelt’s New Nationalism (Doc 14) legitimized active government regulation of big business.

EVIDENCE & REASONING (LIMITS): Reform largely left Black Americans behind. Washington’s accommodation (Doc 9) and the Du Bois–Niagara demand for immediate rights (Docs 10–11) show the struggle for basic civil rights was only beginning, and the Nineteenth Amendment (Doc 13) still left many Black women disenfranchised. The Triangle fire (Doc 6) shows how deadly conditions remained even as reform advanced.

SOURCING: Tarbell (Doc 1) wrote as a crusading journalist — her purpose drove reform but shaped her framing. Washington (Doc 9) spoke to a white audience whose support he needed, which helps explain the compromises in his message.

COMPLEXITY: The Progressive Era both expanded democracy (regulation, suffrage, exposure of corruption) and exposed its limits (racial exclusion, persistent danger). The reforms were real but unequal — a more just society for some Americans more than others.

Rubric & Scoring Guidance

Criterion	What earns the points
Claim / Thesis (1)	Award for a defensible claim that takes a position on how much reform made society more democratic/just and previews a line of reasoning. A restated prompt does not earn it.
Evidence from documents (2)	2 pts: specific, accurate evidence from four or more documents. 1 pt: two–three. Evidence must support the claim, not just appear.
Reasoning (1)	Award when the student explains how a document supports the claim (e.g., why the Pure Food and Drug Act counts as “more just”), not just what it says.
Sourcing / HIPPO (1)	Award when, for at least two documents, the student explains how point of view, purpose, situation, or audience matters — e.g., Tarbell’s crusading purpose, or Washington’s white audience.
Complexity (1)	Award for weighing both the successes and the limits of reform — ideally recognizing that the era expanded justice for some while leaving others (especially Black Americans) behind. A one-sided answer does not earn it.

U.S. HISTORY HACK™

UNIT 3



Imperialism & World War I

1890-1920 • US.19-US.27



TROOPTOTEACHER TECHNOLOGIES LLC

DBQ Answer Key & Scoring Guide

Teacher-facing document. Model answers are strong exemplars to guide scoring — not the only acceptable responses. Accept any answer that is accurate and well-supported by the documents.

Document Answer Notes

DOC 1 The United States Looking Outward

US.19

ANALYZE

What does Mahan argue the United States must do to become a great power — and why?

✓ Build a powerful navy, acquire overseas bases and coaling stations, and control key trade routes (the Caribbean, the Panama isthmus) to protect its growing commerce and rank among the great powers.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Mahan was a naval strategist campaigning for a bigger navy. How might that stake shape his claim that America simply “must” look outward?

✓ As a naval strategist lobbying for a bigger navy, Mahan had a professional stake in arguing that sea power and expansion were necessities, not choices — his purpose fuels the urgency of “must ... look outward.”

DOC 2 Our Country

US.19

ANALYZE

How does Strong use religion and race to justify American expansion?

✓ He claims God is preparing the Anglo-Saxon race to spread Christianity and civilization worldwide, and that “survival of the fittest” means it will naturally dominate “weaker” races — casting expansion as a divine, racial mission.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Strong frames conquest as a divine mission and “survival of the fittest.” How could that framing make imperialism feel righteous — even inevitable — rather than self-interested?

✓ Framing conquest as God’s plan and natural law makes imperialism feel righteous and inevitable rather than greedy, letting expansionists claim the moral high ground.

DOC 3 The White Man's Burden

US.20

ANALYZE

How does Kipling portray both the colonizer and the colonized in this poem?

✓ The colonizer is noble, self-sacrificing, and “burdened”; the colonized are “sullen,” “half-devil and half-child” — savage, childlike peoples who supposedly need to be ruled.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The poem directly addressed Americans debating whether to keep the Philippines. How does its language (“half-devil and half-child”) expose the racial assumptions beneath the “civilizing mission”?

✓ Addressed to Americans deciding on the Philippines, the poem’s racist language exposes that the “civilizing mission” rested on assuming non-white peoples were inferior and incapable of governing themselves.

DOC 4 On Keeping the Philippines

US.20

ANALYZE

How does McKinley justify the decision to keep the Philippines?

✓ He justifies keeping the Philippines as a God-guided moral duty to “uplift and civilize and Christianize” Filipinos, claiming there was no other honorable option.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

This is a secondhand account of McKinley’s private reasoning, retold years later. How does its religious, paternalistic framing echo Kipling’s poem (Doc 3) — and why treat a secondhand quote cautiously?

✓ It is a secondhand account retold years later, so its exact wording is uncertain; still, its paternalistic, religious framing matches Kipling (Doc 3) and the era’s civilizing rhetoric — treat the quote’s details cautiously.

DOC 5 Platform of the American Anti-Imperialist League

US.20

ANALYZE

On what grounds does the Anti-Imperialist League oppose imperialism?

✓ That imperialism is hostile to liberty, breeds militarism, and violates the Declaration’s principles: governments derive their power from the consent of the governed, so ruling a people without consent is “criminal aggression.”

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The League invokes “the land of Washington and Lincoln” and “consent of the governed.” How does turning America’s founding ideals against imperialism make their argument especially sharp?

✓ By invoking “the land of Washington and Lincoln” and “consent of the governed,” the League turns America’s own founding ideals into a weapon against empire, framing imperialism as a betrayal of the nation’s identity.

DOC 6 The Roosevelt Corollary to the Monroe Doctrine**US.21****ANALYZE**

What power does the Roosevelt Corollary claim for the United States, and how does it justify it?

✓ It claims the U.S. right to act as an “international police power,” intervening in Latin American nations guilty of “chronic wrongdoing” or instability, justified by the Monroe Doctrine.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Roosevelt calls this a “police power.” How does that word choice frame U.S. intervention as keeping order rather than building an empire?

✓ Calling it a “police power” frames intervention as neutral order-keeping and responsibility rather than domination — making empire sound like a reluctant duty.

DOC 7 Protest Against the Annexation of Hawaii**US.21****ANALYZE**

On what grounds does Lili‘uokalani protest the annexation of Hawaii?

✓ That annexation ignores her people’s civil rights and property, wrongs the native and part-native Hawaiians, and is “untrue to the international professions of the United States.”

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Most imperialism sources come from the colonizers. What does hearing from Lili‘uokalani — the leader of a people being annexed — reveal that those other sources leave out?

✓ Hearing from the leader of the annexed people reveals the human cost and the hypocrisy that colonizer sources omit — that a self-governing nation was taken against its people’s will.

DOC 8 War Message to Congress**US.23****ANALYZE**

How does Wilson justify American entry into World War I?

✓ As a selfless moral crusade to “make the world safe for democracy” and defend the rights of mankind — explicitly not for conquest, territory, or payment.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Wilson insists the U.S. seeks “no conquest, no dominion.” How does that claim sit against the imperialism documents (Docs 1–7) from only a few years earlier?

✓ Wilson’s claim of “no conquest, no dominion” clashes with the imperialism of Docs 1–7; the U.S. had just taken the Philippines and Hawaii, so the idealistic framing is partly aspirational and partly a tool to unite a divided public.

DOC 9 The Zimmermann Telegram**US.23****ANALYZE**

Why would the Zimmermann Telegram push the United States toward war?

✓ Germany secretly proposed a military alliance with Mexico against the U.S., offering to help Mexico retake Texas, New Mexico, and Arizona — a direct threat to American territory.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

This was secret German communication, not public propaganda. Why does that make it especially persuasive evidence for Americans who wanted to enter the war?

✓ Because it is secret internal German communication rather than propaganda, Americans read it as unfiltered proof of German hostility, which made it far more persuasive for entering the war.

DOC 10 How We Advertised America**US.24****ANALYZE**

How does Creel describe the government's wartime information campaign — and how does he distinguish it from “propaganda”?

✓ As a giant advertising / “salesmanship” campaign to sell the war to Americans, which Creel insists was “educational” fact rather than “propaganda” — a word he ties to the Germans.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Creel, who ran a propaganda agency, insists his work was “education,” not “propaganda.” Why would he draw that line — and should a historian accept his word for it?

✓ As the propaganda chief himself, Creel had every reason to rebrand his work as neutral “education.” A historian should be skeptical: shaping opinion through selective “facts” is exactly what propaganda does.

DOC 11 Schenck v. United States**US.25****ANALYZE**

How did the Supreme Court justify limiting free speech during wartime?

✓ By ruling that speech creating a “clear and present danger” — like urging draft resistance in wartime — is not protected, so wartime needs can override normal free-speech rights.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Wilson said the U.S. was fighting for democracy abroad (Doc 8). How does jailing citizens for antiwar speech at home complicate that claim?

✓ The U.S. claimed to fight for democracy abroad (Doc 8) while jailing citizens for antiwar speech at home, exposing a contradiction between America’s stated ideals and its wartime actions.

DOC 12 The Fourteen Points**US.26****ANALYZE****What kind of peace does Wilson envision in the Fourteen Points?**

✓ A hopeful, principled peace: open diplomacy, fair adjustment of colonial claims, self-determination for peoples, and a League of Nations to guarantee independence and prevent future wars.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Wilson champions self-determination for peoples. How does that ideal sit uneasily beside America's own recent imperialism in the Philippines and Hawaii (Docs 3–7)?**

✓ Wilson's championing of self-determination is hard to square with the U.S. denying it to Filipinos and Hawaiians (Docs 3–7) — revealing a gap between American ideals abroad and American actions.

DOC 13 The Treaty of Versailles — Article 231**US.26****ANALYZE****How do the terms of Article 231 compare with the ideals of Wilson's Fourteen Points (Doc 12)?**

✓ It forces Germany to accept full responsibility for the war and its damages, contradicting Wilson's call for a fair "peace without victory" and providing the legal basis for harsh reparations.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Wilson had called for "peace without victory," yet the treaty blamed Germany entirely. What does that gap reveal about the difference between wartime ideals and peace terms?**

✓ The gap between Wilson's idealistic Fourteen Points and the punitive treaty shows how wartime ideals give way to victors' demands once fighting ends — and it sowed the resentment behind World War II.

DOC 14 Speech Against the League of Nations**US.27****ANALYZE****On what grounds does Lodge oppose U.S. membership in the League of Nations?**

✓ That the League would dilute American loyalty and sovereignty by binding the U.S. to a foreign "mongrel" body; he insists on putting the United States first.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Lodge frames the League as a threat to American independence. How does his fear of internationalism reflect anxiety about the very sovereignty the U.S. had just used to become a world power?**

✓ Lodge's fear that internationalism would erode U.S. independence reflects the same nationalism that fueled American power abroad — now turned inward to protect sovereignty and reject binding commitments.

Model HIPPO Source Analysis

Worked examples for two documents. Use to model sourcing for students.

Doc 3 — The White Man’s Burden (Rudyard Kipling, 1899)

H — Historical Context	Published in 1899, just as the U.S. debated whether to keep the Philippines after the Spanish-American War.
I — Intended Audience	American readers and policymakers deciding whether to build an overseas empire.
P — Purpose	To urge the United States to take up colonial rule as a noble, civilizing duty.
P — Point of View	Kipling was a British imperialist who celebrated empire and assumed white racial superiority.
O — Outside Information	Connects to the Philippine-American War, Social Darwinism, and the “civilizing mission” ideology.

Doc 8 — War Message to Congress (Woodrow Wilson, 1917)

H — Historical Context	Delivered in April 1917 after Germany’s unrestricted submarine warfare and the Zimmermann Telegram.
I — Intended Audience	Congress and a divided, largely neutral American public.
P — Purpose	To win support for a declaration of war by framing it as a moral crusade rather than a war for gain.
P — Point of View	Wilson needed to unite a reluctant public behind war, so he cast it in the highest idealistic terms.
O — Outside Information	Connects to the Fourteen Points, “make the world safe for democracy,” and the later letdown at Versailles.

Model DBQ Response (CER)

THE QUESTION

Between 1890 and 1920 the United States became a world power. Using the documents in this packet, evaluate the extent to which American imperialism and involvement in World War I reflected — or contradicted — the nation’s stated ideals of liberty and self-government.

CLAIM: As the United States became a world power, it loudly proclaimed ideals of liberty and self-government but repeatedly contradicted them — ruling other peoples without their consent abroad and suppressing dissent at home — so its rise reflected those ideals more in rhetoric than in practice.

Evidence & Reasoning (the rhetoric of ideals): Expansionists cast empire as a noble mission — Strong’s divine Anglo-Saxon destiny (Doc 2), Kipling’s “burden” (Doc 3), and McKinley’s duty to “civilize” (Doc 4) — and Wilson framed World War I as a fight to “make the world safe for democracy” (Doc 8), promising self-determination in the Fourteen Points (Doc 12).

Evidence & Reasoning (the contradiction): In practice the nation denied liberty and self-government. It annexed Hawaii over Queen Lili‘uokalani’s protest (Doc 7) and ruled the Philippines against Filipinos’ will; the Roosevelt Corollary claimed a right to “police” Latin America (Doc 6); and at home Schenck (Doc 11) upheld jailing citizens for antiwar speech even as Wilson preached democracy. The Anti-Imperialist League (Doc 5) said empire betrayed “the land of Washington and Lincoln.”

SOURCING: Kipling (Doc 3), a British imperialist, wrote to persuade Americans to embrace empire — his racial assumptions expose the ideology’s core. Wilson’s War Message (Doc 8) was crafted to unite a neutral public, so its soaring idealism also served a political purpose.

COMPLEXITY: The era’s defining tension is that the U.S. expanded its power while claiming to spread liberty — sometimes sincerely (self-determination, anti-imperialist dissent), but often as a cover for domination — so its ideals and its actions pulled in opposite directions.

Rubric & Scoring Guidance

Criterion	What earns the points
Claim / Thesis (1)	Award for a defensible claim that takes a position on how far U.S. actions matched its ideals and previews a line of reasoning. A restated prompt does not earn it.
Evidence from documents (2)	2 pts: specific, accurate evidence from four or more documents. 1 pt: two–three. Evidence must support the claim, not merely appear.
Reasoning (1)	Award when the student explains how a document supports the claim (e.g., why annexing Hawaii “contradicts self-government”), not just what it says.
Sourcing / HIPPO (1)	Award when, for at least two documents, the student explains how point of view, purpose, situation, or audience matters — e.g., Kipling’s imperialist purpose, or Wilson’s need to rally a neutral public.
Complexity (1)	Award for weighing both sides — ideals proclaimed vs. ideals contradicted — ideally recognizing that the U.S. expanded power while claiming to spread liberty. A one-sided answer does not earn it.

U.S. HISTORY HACK™



by TroopToTeacher

UNIT 4



The Roaring Twenties



1920-1929 • US.28-US.38

TROOPTOTEACHER TECHNOLOGIES LLC

DBQ Answer Key & Scoring Guide

The 1920s (1920–1929)
Standards US.28 – US.38

Teacher-facing document. Model answers are strong exemplars to guide scoring — not the only acceptable responses. Accept any answer that is accurate and well-supported by the documents.

Document Answer Notes

DOC 1 The Business of America

US.28

ANALYZE

How does Coolidge describe the values and priorities of 1920s America?

✓ As a nation focused above all on business — producing, buying, selling, investing, and prospering — which Coolidge casts as itself a form of idealism.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Coolidge was a pro-business Republican president during a boom. How might his position shape the way he frames Americans' focus on business as “idealism”?

✓ As a pro-business president during a boom, Coolidge had every reason to celebrate the business ethos and to dress up materialism as “idealism,” making prosperity sound noble rather than merely acquisitive.

DOC 2 Middletown: Installment Buying

US.29

ANALYZE

How did installment buying change the way Americans lived and spent in the 1920s?

✓ Installment credit — “buy now, pay later” — let ordinary families buy cars, radios, and appliances on debt, turning former luxuries into everyday “necessities.”

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

This is sociologists' analysis of an “average” town. Why might a study of everyday spending reveal shifts in values that a political speech (Doc 1) would miss?

✓ As a sociological study of everyday spending in an “average” town, it captures the ordinary reality of consumer culture — shifting habits and values — that a politician's speech (Doc 1) would gloss over.

DOC 3 I, Too**US.31****ANALYZE**

How does Hughes claim African Americans' place in the nation in this poem?

✓ He insists African Americans belong fully in the nation: pushed aside now ("sent to eat in the kitchen"), but growing strong and certain to take a seat "at the table" — "I, too, am America."

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Hughes echoes Walt Whitman's "I Hear America Singing." How does adding "I, too" turn a patriotic image into a demand for equality?

✓ By echoing Whitman's "I Hear America Singing" and adding "I, too," Hughes converts a patriotic image into a claim of equality and a confident prediction of change.

DOC 4 Africa for the Africans**US.32****ANALYZE**

What vision for Black progress does Garvey offer, and how does it differ from seeking integration?

✓ Black self-reliance, racial pride, worldwide unity, and reclaiming Africa ("Africa for the Africans") — building independent Black power rather than seeking white acceptance.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Compare Garvey with Langston Hughes (Doc 3). One demands a place at America's table; the other looks toward Africa. What do these different responses reveal about Black options in the 1920s?

✓ Hughes seeks a place at America's table (Doc 3); Garvey looks toward Africa and separate Black institutions. The contrast shows the range of Black strategies in the 1920s — integration vs. nationalism.

DOC 5 The Eighteenth Amendment**US.33****ANALYZE**

What did the Eighteenth Amendment prohibit, and what did reformers hope it would achieve?

✓ It banned making, selling, and transporting alcohol nationwide; reformers hoped to cut crime, poverty, and family harm and to protect traditional morality.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Prohibition was meant to protect traditional morality but led to widespread lawbreaking. How can this amendment be read as evidence of a clash between traditional and modern values?

✓ Meant to defend traditional morality, Prohibition instead produced speakeasies, bootlegging, and organized crime — a clear example of a clash between traditional values and modern behavior.

DOC 6 The Immigration Act of 1924

US.34

ANALYZE

How did the Immigration Act of 1924 use quotas to shape who could enter the United States?

✓ It capped each nationality at 2% of its population in the 1890 U.S. census, deliberately favoring northern and western Europeans while slashing southern and eastern Europeans and barring most Asians.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Congress based quotas on the 1890 census rather than a more recent one. What does that deliberate choice reveal about the law's real purpose?

✓ Using the 1890 census — before the wave of “new immigrants” — was a deliberate choice to keep out southern and eastern Europeans, revealing the law's nativist purpose.

DOC 7 Vanzetti's Last Statement

US.34

ANALYZE

How does Vanzetti connect his case to prejudice against immigrants and radicals?

✓ He believes he suffered for being an Italian immigrant and a radical, and he finds meaning in becoming a symbol in the fight for justice and tolerance.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Vanzetti spoke these words knowing he would die. How does that context shape both the power of his statement and the way a historian should weigh it as evidence?

✓ Spoken facing execution, his words carry moral weight but are also shaped to move sympathizers; a historian weighs both their sincerity and their rhetorical purpose.

DOC 8 The Scopes Trial

US.35

ANALYZE

How does Bryan frame the conflict between evolution and religion?

✓ As a “duel to the death” between evolution and Christianity, and he argues the people of Tennessee — not scientists or outsiders — have the right to decide what their schools teach.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Bryan appeals to majority rule (“the people of Tennessee have a right”), while modernists appealed to science. What does this clash reveal about competing sources of authority in the 1920s?

✓ Bryan appeals to majority rule and religion; modernists appealed to science. The clash shows two competing sources of authority — democratic/traditional faith vs. scientific expertise — colliding in the 1920s.

DOC 9 The Klan's Fight for Americanism

US.34

ANALYZE

How does Evans use fear of a changing America to justify the Klan?

✓ He claims the Klan speaks for ordinary white Protestant “pioneer stock” Americans and blames immigrants and “aliens” for crowding them out of their own country.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Evans presents the Klan as defending “real” Americans. How does his argument connect to the Immigration Act (Doc 6) as part of a broader nativist backlash?

✓ Evans’s rhetoric and the Immigration Act (Doc 6) are two faces of the same nativist backlash — one a mass movement, one a federal law — both defining “real” Americans narrowly.

DOC 10 Flapper Jane

US.30

ANALYZE

What does “Flapper Jane” reveal about changing expectations for women in the 1920s?

✓ That young women were rejecting old rules of dress and behavior in the name of honesty and freedom — “coming off the pedestal” — reflecting women’s changing role after winning the vote.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

This is a male journalist describing a young woman for a magazine audience. How might his point of view and purpose shape how “Flapper Jane” is portrayed?

✓ A male journalist is describing a young woman for a magazine audience; his purpose (to entertain and provoke) and his point of view shape how liberated — or how sensational — “Flapper Jane” appears.

DOC 11 A Letter from the Great Migration

US.32

ANALYZE

What does this letter reveal about why African Americans left the South during the Great Migration?

✓ To escape the “darkness” and “suffering” of the Jim Crow South and find work, schooling for the children, and a fair chance in the North.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

This is an ordinary person’s private letter, not a public statement. What does that firsthand voice capture that a law or a speech could not?

✓ As an ordinary person’s private letter, it captures the personal desperation and hope behind the Great Migration that a statistic or a law cannot convey.

DOC 12 Rugged Individualism**US.28****ANALYZE**

What does Hoover’s idea of “rugged individualism” value, and what does it reject?

✓ It values self-reliance, free enterprise, and limited government; it rejects government involvement in business as “paternalism” that would stifle initiative and equal opportunity.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Hoover gave this speech at the height of the boom, a year before the Crash. How might that timing make his confidence in individualism look different in hindsight?

✓ Delivered at the boom’s peak, a year before the Crash, Hoover’s faith in individualism would soon look badly misplaced — context that makes the source ironic in hindsight.

DOC 13 A Return to Normalcy**US.28****ANALYZE**

What mood and priorities does Harding’s call for “normalcy” express after World War I?

✓ A calming turn away from war, reform, and crusades toward healing, stability, and “triumphant nationality” — signaling isolationism and the end of Progressive activism.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Harding rejects “submergence in internationality” for “triumphant nationality.” How does this connect to the rejection of the League of Nations at the end of the previous era?

✓ Rejecting “submergence in internationality” connects directly to the Senate’s rejection of the League of Nations — a continued retreat from world involvement into the 1920s.

DOC 14 The Great Gatsby**US.30****ANALYZE**

How does Fitzgerald use the “green light” to comment on the American Dream?

✓ The green light stands for Gatsby’s hopes and the American Dream — a future chased “faster” each year that keeps receding, suggesting the Dream may be an illusion.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

This is a novelist’s critique, not a factual record. How can a work of fiction still be valuable evidence of how people experienced the 1920s?

✓ Though fiction, the novel is evidence of how thoughtful contemporaries experienced the era’s glamour and emptiness — the mood and meaning of the Jazz Age, if not its literal facts.

Model HIPPO Source Analysis

Worked examples for two documents. Use to model sourcing for students.

Doc 8 — The Scopes Trial (William Jennings Bryan, 1925)

H — Historical Context	Delivered during the 1925 Scopes Trial in Tennessee, which had banned teaching evolution — the peak of the fundamentalist-modernist culture war.
I — Intended Audience	The court, and the national press and public following the sensational trial.
P — Purpose	To defend the anti-evolution law and traditional Christian belief and to assert the public’s right to control the schools.
P — Point of View	Bryan was a devout fundamentalist and three-time presidential candidate who championed rural, religious America.
O — Outside Information	Connects to fundamentalism, the rural-urban divide, and the rise of modern science.

Doc 10 — Flapper Jane (Bruce Bliven, 1925)

H — Historical Context	Published in 1925, after the 19th Amendment, amid new freedoms for young urban women and a backlash against them.
I — Intended Audience	The New Republic’s educated, mostly urban readership.
P — Purpose	To describe — and partly celebrate and sensationalize — the modern “flapper” for a magazine audience.
P — Point of View	Bruce Bliven, a male journalist, observing and interpreting a young woman from the outside.
O — Outside Information	Connects to woman suffrage, consumer culture, and the decade’s culture war over gender.

Model DBQ Response (CER)

THE QUESTION

The 1920s brought rapid cultural and economic change to the United States. Using the documents in this packet, evaluate the extent to which the decade was defined by conflict between traditional and modern values.

CLAIM: The 1920s were defined by a sharp conflict between traditional and modern values: as a new consumer culture, art, and set of freedoms surged forward, a powerful traditional backlash used law and organized movements to defend an older America.

Evidence & Reasoning (modern change): The decade embraced the modern. Coolidge celebrated a business-and-consumer nation (Doc 1), installment credit remade daily life (Doc 2), the Harlem Renaissance gave proud voice to Black identity (Doc 3), and the “flapper” (Doc 10) and Gatsby’s Jazz Age (Doc 14) captured new freedoms and restless striving.

Evidence & Reasoning (traditional backlash): Against this, traditionalists fought back. Prohibition tried to enforce older morality (Doc 5); the Immigration Act of 1924 (Doc 6) and the revived Klan (Doc 9) defended a narrow, nativist vision of “real” Americans; and Bryan’s stand at the Scopes Trial (Doc 8) pitted religion against modern science.

SOURCING: Bryan (Doc 8) spoke as a fundamentalist leader defending rural, religious America, which shaped his framing of evolution as a mortal threat. The “Flapper Jane” article (Doc 10), written by a male journalist for a magazine, both reported and sensationalized women’s new freedom.

COMPLEXITY: The conflict was real but uneven — modern change and traditional backlash often clashed over the same issues (race, immigration, gender, faith), and many Americans, like the Great Migration letter-writer (Doc 11) or Vanzetti (Doc 7), were caught in the tension rather than firmly on one side.

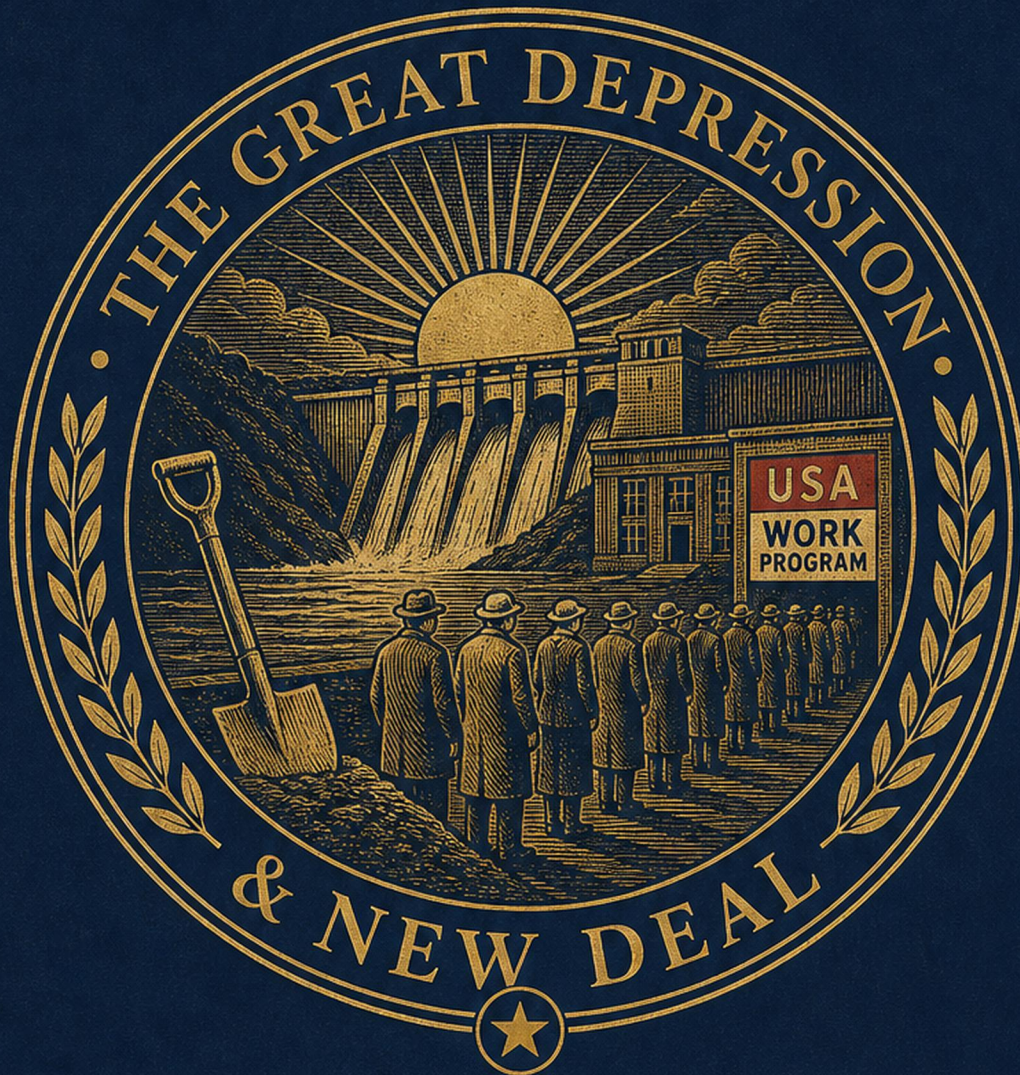
Rubric & Scoring Guidance

Criterion	What earns the points
Claim / Thesis (1)	Award for a defensible claim that takes a position on how far the decade was defined by tradition-vs-modernity conflict and previews a line of reasoning. A restated prompt does not earn it.
Evidence from documents (2)	2 pts: specific, accurate evidence from four or more documents. 1 pt: two–three. Evidence must support the claim, not merely appear.
Reasoning (1)	Award when the student explains how a document supports the claim (e.g., why Prohibition counts as “traditional backlash”), not just what it says.
Sourcing / HIPPO (1)	Award when, for at least two documents, the student explains how point of view, purpose, situation, or audience matters — e.g., Bryan’s fundamentalist purpose, or the male journalist behind “Flapper Jane.”
Complexity (1)	Award for weighing both sides — modern change and traditional backlash — ideally recognizing that they clashed over the same issues or that some Americans were caught between them. A one-sided answer does not earn it.

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UNIT 5



The Great Depression & New Deal

1929-1941 • US.39-US.44

★
TROOPTOTEACHER TECHNOLOGIES LLC

DBQ Answer Key & Scoring Guide

The Great Depression and New Deal (1929–1941)
Standards US.39 – US.44

Teacher-facing document. Model answers are strong exemplars to guide scoring — not the only acceptable responses. Accept any answer that is accurate and well-supported by the documents.

Document Answer Notes

DOC 1 First Inaugural Address

US.40

ANALYZE

How does FDR try to restore confidence and signal a new role for government in this speech?

✓ Through calm reassurance (“fear itself”) and a promise of bold, immediate federal action — even the government hiring people directly — treating unemployment like a wartime emergency and signaling a far more active government.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

FDR says government should treat unemployment “as we would treat the emergency of a war.” How does that comparison prepare Americans to accept an unprecedented expansion of federal action?

✓ Framing the crisis as a “war” emergency prepares Americans to accept federal powers they would normally resist, because wartime is understood to justify extraordinary action.

DOC 2 Against the Federal Dole

US.39

ANALYZE

Why does Hoover oppose direct federal relief during the Depression?

✓ Local governments and private, voluntary charity should provide relief; federal handouts, he argues, would weaken self-government and make communities dependent on a “remote bureaucracy.”

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Hoover’s faith in local, voluntary aid clashes with FDR’s call for federal “action now” (Doc 1). What does this contrast reveal about competing ideas of government’s role?

✓ Hoover’s local/voluntary approach versus FDR’s federal “action now” (Doc 1) captures the core debate of the era: whether Washington should take responsibility for citizens’ welfare.

DOC 3 Letters from the Dust Bowl**US.39****ANALYZE**

What does this letter reveal about the human experience of the Dust Bowl?

✓ The relentless, choking dust that seeps through sealed walls — a terrifying, near-hopeless environmental disaster layered on top of the economic one.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

This is a firsthand letter, not a government report. What does an eyewitness voice capture about the Dust Bowl that statistics on crop failure could not?

✓ A firsthand letter conveys the sensory terror and daily struggle — “no report can convey the reality” — that statistics on crop failure cannot.

DOC 4 A Letter to the White House**US.41****ANALYZE**

What does this letter reveal about how ordinary Americans experienced the Depression — and how they viewed the Roosevelts?

✓ Work, food, and shoes so the children can attend school; more broadly, that families were desperate and looked to the Roosevelts personally for help while clinging to their dignity.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The writer insists they “only want a chance to work” and “hate to ask for charity.” What does that reveal about how Americans felt about accepting relief?

✓ Insisting they “hate to ask for charity” and “only want a chance to work” shows the shame many Americans felt about relief and their deep belief in self-reliance even in crisis.

DOC 5 First Fireside Chat**US.40****ANALYZE**

How does FDR use the fireside chat to restore Americans’ confidence?

✓ By explaining the banking crisis calmly and personally over the radio and urging people to return their money to reopened banks — arguing that public confidence itself is essential to recovery.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

FDR chose radio to speak “with” — not “to” — the people. How might that intimate, direct style build support for his programs more effectively than a formal speech?

✓ The intimate radio style makes listeners feel FDR is speaking with them, building personal trust that translates into broad support for his programs.

DOC 6 The Social Security Act

US.42

ANALYZE

How did the Social Security Act change the federal government's responsibility toward its citizens?

✓ It made the federal government permanently responsible for citizens' basic economic security — old-age pensions, unemployment insurance, and aid to the disabled and needy children — a fundamentally new role.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Social Security made the federal government permanently responsible for citizens' economic security. How is that a bigger change than temporary relief programs?

✓ Unlike temporary relief, Social Security created a permanent federal safety net — a structural, lasting change in what government owes its people.

DOC 7 The Wagner Act

US.42

ANALYZE

How did the Wagner Act change the relationship between workers, employers, and the federal government?

✓ It guaranteed workers the right to organize unions and bargain collectively, throwing federal power behind labor and protecting organizing from employer retaliation.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

By protecting unions, the federal government took the workers' side in disputes with employers. How was that a major shift from earlier government policy toward labor?

✓ By protecting unions, the government took labor's side against employers — a major reversal from earlier policy, which had often backed business.

DOC 8 A Civilian Conservation Corps Enrollee

US.42

ANALYZE

How did New Deal work programs like the CCC help both individuals and their families?

✓ Food, clothing, shelter, work, and pay — most of it sent home — supporting both the young men and their families and providing relief with dignity.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

This is a fond personal recollection. How might gratitude and the passage of time shape how the CCC is remembered — and how should a historian weigh such a source?

✓ A fond recollection recalled later may idealize the program; a historian weighs its warmth against more critical or contemporary evidence.

DOC 9 Second Inaugural Address

US.42

ANALYZE

How does FDR define national progress in this speech, and what role does he give the government?

✓ As providing “enough for those who have too little” rather than adding to the abundance of the rich — defining progress morally and justifying continued, active government.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

FDR measures progress by how the nation treats “those who have too little.” How does that standard justify a permanently larger role for the federal government?

✓ Measuring progress by how the poorest are treated frames an expanded, activist government as a moral duty, not merely an emergency measure.

DOC 10 Every Man a King

US.43

ANALYZE

How does Long criticize the New Deal, and what does he propose instead?

✓ He says the New Deal does not go far enough for the poor; he would cap great fortunes and guarantee every family a home, car, and comforts — “Every man a king.”

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Long and the New Deal both claimed to help the “forgotten man.” How does his critique from the left differ from conservatives who said the New Deal went too far (Docs 11–12)?

✓ Long attacks from the left (do more; redistribute), while conservatives (Docs 11–12) attacked from the right (do less) — showing FDR was squeezed from both sides.

DOC 11 Schechter Poultry Corp. v. United States

US.43

ANALYZE

On what constitutional grounds did the Court strike down this New Deal program?

✓ It struck down the NRA as an unconstitutional delegation of legislative power, ruling that even a national emergency cannot enlarge the president’s constitutional authority.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The Court says “extraordinary conditions do not create or enlarge constitutional power.” How does this ruling reflect a fear that the New Deal gave the president too much power?

✓ The ruling reflects a fear that the New Deal concentrated too much power in the executive — a check on FDR that helped push him toward the court fight (Doc 13).

DOC 12 Statement of the American Liberty League

US.43

ANALYZE

How does the American Liberty League argue that the New Deal went too far?

✓ That the New Deal foments class antagonism, kills individual initiative and self-reliance, and dangerously concentrates “un-American” power in the president — threatening the Constitution.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The Liberty League was funded by wealthy businessmen. How might that stake shape its claim that the New Deal threatened “the fundamental principles” of the country?

✓ Funded by wealthy businessmen who stood to lose from taxes and regulation, the League had a clear stake in portraying the New Deal as a threat to liberty rather than a help to the poor.

DOC 13 Fireside Chat on the Federal Judiciary

US.44

ANALYZE

How does FDR justify his plan to change the Supreme Court?

✓ He accuses the Court of acting as a “policy-making body” that blocks the nation’s will, and justifies adding justices as “saving the Constitution from the Court.”

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Even many New Deal supporters opposed the court plan. What does that backlash reveal about American limits on concentrating power — even for popular goals?

✓ Even many New Deal supporters recoiled at “court-packing,” showing Americans’ limits on concentrating power — a popular president could still be checked.

DOC 14 Eleanor Roosevelt on a Democracy’s Duty

US.41

ANALYZE

How does Eleanor Roosevelt define the responsibilities of a democracy toward its people?

✓ That a democracy must provide not just the vote but “the chance to live in decency and hope,” and that the true test of civilization is whether it helps those who have fallen behind.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Eleanor Roosevelt frames helping the poor as the “test of our civilization.” How does this moral argument support the New Deal’s expansion of government (Docs 6, 9)?

✓ Her moral argument — helping the poor as the “test of our civilization” — supplies the ethical justification for the New Deal’s expansion of government (Docs 6, 9).

Model HIPPO Source Analysis

Worked examples for two documents. Use to model sourcing for students.

Doc 1 — First Inaugural Address (Franklin D. Roosevelt, 1933)

H — Historical Context	Delivered in March 1933 at the depths of the Depression — about 25% unemployment and a collapsing banking system.
I — Intended Audience	The American people, desperate and fearful.
P — Purpose	To restore public confidence and win support for bold, immediate federal action.
P — Point of View	FDR, the incoming president, needed to project strength and justify an unusually active government.
O — Outside Information	Connects to the Hundred Days, the bank holiday, and the launch of the New Deal.

Doc 12 — Statement of the American Liberty League (1935)

H — Historical Context	Issued in 1935 as the New Deal expanded with Social Security and the Wagner Act.
I — Intended Audience	The public, and conservative and business Americans skeptical of FDR.
P — Purpose	To rally opposition to the New Deal and defend free enterprise and limited government.
P — Point of View	The Liberty League was funded by wealthy businessmen who opposed higher taxes and regulation.
O — Outside Information	Connects to conservative resistance, the Schechter case, and the 1936 election.

Model DBQ Response (CER)

THE QUESTION

The Great Depression tested the United States as no economic crisis had before. Using the documents in this packet, evaluate the extent to which the New Deal changed the relationship between the federal government and the American people.

CLAIM: The New Deal fundamentally and permanently changed the relationship between the federal government and the American people — making Washington responsible for citizens’ economic security for the first time — even though critics on the right and the left, and the courts, fiercely contested how far that change should go.

Evidence & Reasoning (an expanded government): FDR promised federal “action now” (Doc 1) and used the radio to lead the nation directly (Doc 5); Social Security created a permanent safety net (Doc 6), the Wagner Act put federal power behind labor (Doc 7), the CCC provided relief with dignity (Doc 8), and FDR redefined progress as caring for “those who have too little” (Doc 9).

Evidence & Reasoning (contested limits): The change was bitterly disputed. The American Liberty League (Doc 12) and the Supreme Court in *Schechter* (Doc 11) attacked it as unconstitutional overreach, while Huey Long (Doc 10) insisted it did far too little. Even FDR’s court-packing plan (Doc 13) failed, exposing limits on his power.

SOURCING: FDR’s First Inaugural (Doc 1) was crafted to reassure a terrified public and justify activist government, so it frames expansion as necessity. The Liberty League (Doc 12), funded by wealthy businessmen, had a clear stake in casting the New Deal as a threat to liberty.

COMPLEXITY: The New Deal permanently enlarged government’s role — Social Security still exists today — yet it was neither the full redistribution Long demanded nor the tyranny its enemies feared. It was a contested middle path that redefined, without revolutionizing, the government’s duty to its people.

Rubric & Scoring Guidance

Criterion	What earns the points
Claim / Thesis (1)	Award for a defensible claim that takes a position on how much the New Deal changed the government–people relationship and previews a line of reasoning. A restated prompt does not earn it.
Evidence from documents (2)	2 pts: specific, accurate evidence from four or more documents. 1 pt: two–three. Evidence must support the claim, not merely appear.
Reasoning (1)	Award when the student explains how a document supports the claim (e.g., why Social Security is a fundamental change), not just what it says.
Sourcing / HIPPO (1)	Award when, for at least two documents, the student explains how point of view, purpose, situation, or audience matters — e.g., FDR’s need to reassure the public, or the businessmen behind the Liberty League.
Complexity (1)	Award for weighing more than one perspective — expansion of government plus the critics who said it went too far and too little — or the tension between them. A one-sided answer does not earn it.

★
U.S. HISTORY HACK™

— BY TROOPTO TEACHER —

UNIT 6

★



WORLD WAR II

★

1939–1945 • US.45–US.58

— TROOPTO TEACHER TECHNOLOGIES LLC —

DBQ Answer Key & Scoring Guide

World War II (1936–1945)
Standards US.45 – US.58

Teacher-facing document. Model answers are strong exemplars to guide scoring — not the only acceptable responses. Accept any answer that is accurate and well-supported by the documents.

Document Answer Notes

DOC 1 The Four Freedoms

US.45

ANALYZE

How does FDR define the ideals the United States should defend?

✓ As four universal freedoms — of speech, of worship, from want, and from fear — that belong to people “everywhere in the world,” giving the coming war a clear moral purpose.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

FDR insists these freedoms belong to people “everywhere in the world.” How might that universal claim be used later to judge America’s own conduct during the war?

✓ Because FDR claims these freedoms for everyone, everywhere, the same standard can be turned back on the U.S. — internment (Docs 4–5) shows the nation failing to live up to its own stated ideals.

DOC 2 America First

US.45

ANALYZE

On what grounds does Lindbergh argue against U.S. entry into the war?

✓ That the U.S. should stay out of the war because its security depends on avoiding Europe’s conflict, not on sympathy for Britain.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Lindbergh appeals to “our own defense.” Given that the same speech was condemned as antisemitic (see note), how should a historian weigh both the argument and the prejudice behind it?

✓ The argument appeals to self-defense, but the same speech blamed Jewish Americans for pushing war; a historian weighs the isolationist reasoning while recognizing the prejudice it was wrapped in.

DOC 3 A Date Which Will Live in Infamy**US.46****ANALYZE**

How does FDR frame the attack on Pearl Harbor to unite the nation for war?

✓ By calling it a deliberate, “premeditated” attack and “a date which will live in infamy,” and promising “absolute victory,” FDR unites a shocked nation behind war.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Just months earlier, many Americans opposed entering the war (Doc 2). How does FDR use Pearl Harbor to end that debate almost overnight?

✓ Just months earlier, isolationists like Lindbergh (Doc 2) had wide support; Pearl Harbor let FDR unite the country almost overnight and end the neutrality debate.

DOC 4 Executive Order 9066**US.51****ANALYZE**

How could this order be used to imprison Japanese Americans — and what does it reveal about wartime fear?

✓ It let the military exclude “any or all persons” from designated areas at its discretion — used to remove about 120,000 Japanese Americans — revealing how wartime fear overrode civil liberties.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The order never mentions Japanese Americans by name. How does its broad, neutral language make it easier to carry out a policy based on race?

✓ The order’s neutral, race-free language made a racially targeted policy easier to carry out and to defend as mere “military necessity.”

DOC 5 Behind Barbed Wire: An Internee Remembers**US.51****ANALYZE**

What does this account reveal about the human cost of Japanese American internment?

✓ Losing home and belongings, then living behind barbed wire under armed guard as an “enemy” despite being a citizen who had done nothing wrong — the human cost of internment.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Read this beside Executive Order 9066 (Doc 4). How does a personal memory reveal what the neutral legal language of the order hides?

✓ The personal memory exposes the fear, humiliation, and injustice that Executive Order 9066’s (Doc 4) bureaucratic language conceals.

DOC 6 Executive Order 8802**US.50****ANALYZE**

What did Executive Order 8802 change, and why was it a significant step for civil rights?

✓ It banned racial discrimination in defense jobs and government — the first federal action against employment discrimination since Reconstruction — won by Black leaders' pressure.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

This order came only after Black leaders threatened a march on Washington. What does that reveal about how rights were won during the war?

✓ It came only because A. Philip Randolph threatened a march on Washington, showing that rights in this era were won through organized pressure, not simply granted.

DOC 7 The Double V Campaign**US.50****ANALYZE**

How does the Double V campaign turn the war for freedom abroad into a demand for equality at home?

✓ Victory over fascism abroad and victory over racism at home — arguing that prejudice within America threatens democracy as much as the Axis powers do.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The Double V argument uses America's own war aims (Doc 1) against its treatment of Black citizens. Why was that a powerful strategy during the war?

✓ By using America's own war-for-freedom rhetoric (Doc 1) against segregation, the campaign made the nation's hypocrisy visible and helped push toward the postwar civil rights movement.

DOC 8 A Woman War Worker Remembers**US.49****ANALYZE**

How did World War II change women's roles and self-image on the home front?

✓ It opened factory jobs once considered "men's work" to women, giving many their first paycheck and a lasting confidence — even though they were pushed out when the war ended.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

She was sent home when the war ended "so the men could have their jobs back." How does that ending complicate the idea that the war permanently changed women's place in society?

✓ Being sent home "so the men could have their jobs back" shows the change was partly temporary — yet the confidence and the precedent outlasted the war.

DOC 9 This Is a People's War**US.49****ANALYZE**

How did the government ask ordinary Americans to contribute to the war effort at home?

✓ To ration goods, buy war bonds, plant victory gardens, and save scrap — framing everyday civilian sacrifice as everyone's share in "a people's war."

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

This is government messaging designed to persuade. How might its cheerful, unifying tone shape the way Americans understood shortages and sacrifice?

✓ As persuasive government messaging, its upbeat, unifying tone reframes shortages as patriotic duty rather than hardship — shaping how Americans experienced sacrifice.

DOC 10 D-Day: Order of the Day**US.52****ANALYZE**

How does Eisenhower frame the D-Day invasion for the soldiers about to fight it?

✓ As a "Great Crusade" watched by "the eyes of the world" and carrying the hopes of "liberty-loving people everywhere" — the fight to free Europe.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Eisenhower calls the invasion a "Great Crusade" for "liberty-loving people everywhere." How does that language connect the fighting to the ideals in FDR's Four Freedoms (Doc 1)?

✓ Eisenhower's "liberty-loving people everywhere" directly echoes the Four Freedoms (Doc 1), tying the soldiers' fight to America's stated ideals.

DOC 11 The Liberation of the Camps**US.55****ANALYZE**

Why did Eisenhower want first-hand evidence of what he saw in the Nazi camps?

✓ So he could bear first-hand witness against anyone who might later dismiss the atrocities as "propaganda" — documenting the Holocaust so it could not be denied.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Eisenhower feared future claims that the atrocities were "propaganda." How does an eyewitness account by a trusted commander guard against Holocaust denial?

✓ An eyewitness account by a trusted, credible commander is powerful evidence against Holocaust denial precisely because he anticipated future deniers.

DOC 12 The Announcement of the Atomic Bomb**US.54****ANALYZE****How does Truman justify and describe the use of the atomic bomb?**

✓ As “a harnessing of the basic power of the universe” used against those who “brought war to the Far East,” warning Japan to surrender or face “a rain of ruin.”

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Truman calls it “a harnessing of the basic power of the universe.” How does that framing present the bomb as both a triumph and a threat?

✓ Framing the bomb as both a scientific triumph and an unstoppable threat justifies its use, warns the enemy, and hints at the terrifying new age it opens.

DOC 13 A Petition to the President**US.54****ANALYZE****Why do these scientists urge caution about using the atomic bomb?**

✓ Not to use the bomb without first making surrender terms public and giving Japan a chance to accept them — fearing the U.S. would set a precedent for “an era of devastation.”

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Read this beside Truman’s announcement (Doc 12). How do the scientists and the President weigh the same weapon so differently — and what shapes each view?

✓ The scientists (who built the bomb) and Truman weigh the same weapon differently: the scientists foreground the moral precedent, while Truman foregrounds ending the war quickly.

DOC 14 The Atlantic Charter**US.57****ANALYZE****What kind of postwar world do Roosevelt and Churchill say the Allies are fighting for?**

✓ A world with no seizing of territory, self-determination for peoples, and the abandonment of force — the ideals that would inspire the United Nations.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The Charter promises “the right of all peoples to choose” their government. How might colonized peoples — and Black Americans (Doc 7) — use that promise to demand their own freedom?

✓ Its promise of “the right of all peoples to choose” their government could be used by colonized peoples and by Black Americans (Doc 7) to demand their own freedom — a promise that ran ahead of Allied practice.

Model HIPPO Source Analysis

Worked examples for two documents. Use to model sourcing for students.

Doc 4 — Executive Order 9066 (Franklin D. Roosevelt, 1942)

H — Historical Context	Issued in February 1942, months after Pearl Harbor, amid fear and anti-Japanese prejudice on the West Coast.
I — Intended Audience	The War Department and military commanders (and, indirectly, the public).
P — Purpose	To authorize removing people from military areas — the legal basis for internment of Japanese Americans.
P — Point of View	The government, prioritizing security — and yielding to prejudice — over civil liberties.
O — Outside Information	Connects to <i>Korematsu v. United States</i> (1944) and the 1988 government apology and reparations.

Doc 7 — The Double V Campaign (Pittsburgh Courier, 1942)

H — Historical Context	Published in 1942, as Black Americans served and worked for a nation that still segregated them.
I — Intended Audience	Black readers of the Pittsburgh Courier and the wider American public.
P — Purpose	To rally Black Americans and demand that the fight for freedom include equality at home.
P — Point of View	A leading Black newspaper advocating civil rights during the war.
O — Outside Information	Connects to Executive Order 8802, the Great Migration, and the postwar civil rights movement.

Model DBQ Response (CER)

THE QUESTION

World War II was fought in the name of freedom. Using the documents in this packet, evaluate the extent to which the United States upheld its stated ideals of freedom and equality during the war.

CLAIM: During World War II the United States proclaimed and fought for freedom — and in some ways advanced it — but it also betrayed those ideals at home and made wrenching moral choices, so it upheld its stated ideals only unevenly.

Evidence & Reasoning (ideals upheld and advanced): The nation defined noble aims in the Four Freedoms (Doc 1) and the Atlantic Charter (Doc 14) and fought to free Europe (Eisenhower’s D-Day order, Doc 10) and confront Nazi atrocities (Doc 11). At home, Black pressure won a ban on defense-job discrimination (Doc 6), and women gained new roles and confidence (Doc 8).

Evidence & Reasoning (ideals betrayed / hard choices): Yet the same government imprisoned about 120,000 Japanese Americans without trial (Docs 4–5), and Black Americans had to wage a Double V campaign (Doc 7) because they were still segregated in the country they served. The atomic bombing (Doc 12), opposed by some of its own makers (Doc 13), raised hard questions about the means used to win.

SOURCING: Executive Order 9066 (Doc 4) is a government order whose neutral language hid a racial policy justified as “military necessity.” The Double V campaign (Doc 7), from a Black newspaper, deliberately used America’s own freedom rhetoric to expose its hypocrisy.

COMPLEXITY: The war both advanced and betrayed American ideals at the same time — fighting tyranny abroad while practicing injustice at home — and that very contradiction, seized on by Black Americans and interned families, helped drive the postwar struggle for civil rights.

Rubric & Scoring Guidance

Criterion	What earns the points
Claim / Thesis (1)	Award for a defensible claim that takes a position on how fully the U.S. upheld its ideals during the war and previews a line of reasoning. A restated prompt does not earn it.
Evidence from documents (2)	2 pts: specific, accurate evidence from four or more documents. 1 pt: two–three. Evidence must support the claim, not merely appear.
Reasoning (1)	Award when the student explains how a document supports the claim (e.g., why internment “betrays” the Four Freedoms), not just what it says.
Sourcing / HIPPO (1)	Award when, for at least two documents, the student explains how point of view, purpose, situation, or audience matters — e.g., EO 9066’s security purpose, or the Black newspaper behind Double V.
Complexity (1)	Award for weighing both sides — ideals upheld and ideals betrayed — ideally recognizing that the war did both at once. A one-sided answer does not earn it.

U.S. HISTORY HACK™

BY TROOPTOTEACHER

UNIT 7



The Cold War

1945-1991 • US.59-US.70

TROOPTOTEACHER TECHNOLOGIES LLC

DBQ Answer Key & Scoring Guide

The Cold War (1945–1991)
Standards US.59 – US.70

Teacher-facing document. Model answers are strong exemplars to guide scoring — not the only acceptable responses. Accept any answer that is accurate and well-supported by the documents.

Document Answer Notes

DOC 1 The Truman Doctrine

US.59

ANALYZE

How does Truman justify a new, active U.S. role in resisting communism abroad?

✓ Truman justifies the new role by redefining a regional crisis as a global moral choice. Rather than arguing that Greece and Turkey matter strategically, he argues that every nation is now choosing between two ways of life — one based on the will of the majority and free institutions, the other on the will of a minority imposed by force. Because the choice is being made under coercion, he says the United States has an obligation to support "free peoples" resisting armed minorities and outside pressure. Aid becomes preventive: a small investment now avoids a larger conflict later. Strong answers notice that he asks for money, not troops, but claims a principle far larger than the money.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Truman frames the world as a stark choice between freedom and tyranny. How might that framing be used to justify almost any intervention against communism, anywhere?

✓ Because the framing is binary and global, almost any anti-communist government can be labeled a "free people," and almost any leftist movement can be labeled an "armed minority." The doctrine sets no geographic limit, no cost ceiling, and no exit condition. Students may connect this to later interventions — Iran (1953), Guatemala (1954), Vietnam — where the U.S. supported governments that were not democratic, precisely because the Truman framework made anti-communism the test rather than freedom itself.

DOC 2 The Marshall Plan

US.59

ANALYZE

How is the Marshall Plan a form of containment through economics rather than military force?

✓ Marshall presents the plan as directed against hunger, poverty, desperation, and chaos rather than against any country or doctrine — deliberately non-ideological language. But the underlying logic is containment: he argues that European economies are broken, that broken economies breed political instability, and that instability is what communism feeds on. Recovery is therefore self-defense. Strong answers also see the American self-interest: a solvent Europe buys American exports and keeps the U.S. economy from sliding back toward depression. Students should note that Marshall insists Europeans design the program themselves, which makes aid look cooperative rather than imperial.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The Soviets forbade Eastern Europe from accepting Marshall aid. How does that reveal the plan as a weapon in the emerging Cold War?

✓ The Soviet response is the tell. Moscow not only refused Marshall aid but forced its satellites — Poland and Czechoslovakia had shown interest — to reject it too, because accepting American money, and the economic openness attached to it, would have loosened Soviet control over Eastern Europe. That reaction exposes the strategic edge beneath the humanitarian language: aid that strengthened Western Europe and pulled it toward the United States necessarily widened the gap between the two blocs. A program "directed against hunger" still functioned as a weapon, hardening the very division of Europe that the Berlin crisis (Doc 5) would soon make concrete.

DOC 3 The Sources of Soviet Conduct

US.59

ANALYZE

What strategy does Kennan propose for dealing with Soviet expansion?

✓ Kennan argues that Soviet hostility is not caused by any specific American action and therefore cannot be fixed by any specific American concession. It grows from Marxist-Leninist ideology fused with a much older Russian sense of insecurity, and it is sustained because the regime needs a foreign enemy to justify internal control. His prescription follows from the diagnosis: since the hostility is structural, the United States should apply long-term, patient, firm, and vigilant counter-pressure at shifting geographic and political points, avoiding both appeasement and provocation, until Soviet power either mellows or breaks up internally.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Kennan later argued containment was meant to be mainly political and economic, not military. How might his idea have been stretched beyond what he intended?

✓ Point of view matters here. Kennan is a career diplomat with direct Moscow experience, writing anonymously as "X" in Foreign Affairs for an elite policymaking audience — not for the general public. That anonymity gave the article the weight of insider authority. Kennan later objected that readers turned his political-economic containment into a global military doctrine (see NSC-68, Doc 4). Students should note the limit of the source: an analytical essay reveals how one influential thinker framed the problem, not what the government actually decided.

ANALYZE

How did NSC-68 transform containment into a military and economic commitment?

✓ NSC-68 converts containment from a selective political strategy into a militarized global commitment. It describes a zero-sum struggle in which any communist gain anywhere is a defeat everywhere, because the loss is measured in credibility as much as territory. From that premise it calls for a large, permanent, and rapid buildup of conventional and nuclear forces, arguing that the United States has the economic capacity to afford it. Strong answers see the shift: Kennan's "apply pressure where it matters" becomes "defend the perimeter everywhere," which effectively removes the ability to rank crises by importance.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

NSC-68 says “a defeat of free institutions anywhere is a defeat everywhere.” How could that logic be used to justify nearly unlimited military spending and intervention?

✓ Because the report defines any communist gain anywhere as a defeat everywhere, it erases the distinction between vital and peripheral interests. If every point on the map is equally decisive, then no commitment can be refused as "not worth it," and no ceiling on military spending is logically defensible — credibility itself becomes the stake in even the smallest conflict. That premise is what lets a single framework justify both a vast nuclear arsenal and a ground war in a country most Americans could not find on a map. Students should trace the logic straight into Doc 7 (Korea) and Doc 11 (Gulf of Tonkin), where distant fights become tests of national survival. (It also helps to note the source: a classified paper written to win an internal budget argument is built to sound alarming.)

ANALYZE

What does the Berlin Airlift reveal about how the U.S. chose to resist Soviet pressure?

✓ Berlin shows containment carried out without combat. Facing a Soviet blockade of the western sectors, the United States and Britain chose to supply more than two million people entirely by air rather than force the roads or abandon the city. The response demonstrates that containment could mean logistics, endurance, and visibility instead of shooting. It also converted a former enemy capital into a symbol: West Berliners became people to be rescued, and the airlift became powerful evidence — at home and abroad — that the American side fed cities while the Soviet side starved them.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The airlift avoided direct combat but risked war every day. Why might this “victory without a shot” have mattered so much early in the Cold War?

✓ Early in the Cold War neither side knew where the line between pressure and open war actually lay, and both feared that a single shot might trigger another world war so soon after the last. A victory won by cargo planes rather than tanks let the United States hold Berlin without handing the Soviets a pretext for combat, and it proved that containment could succeed through endurance and resolve rather than bloodshed. That precedent mattered far beyond Berlin: it established that firmness need not mean war — a lesson that shaped later confrontations, most visibly the calculated restraint of the Cuban Missile Crisis (Doc 9).

DOC 6 **McCarthyism****US.62****ANALYZE****How does McCarthy shift the communist threat from abroad to inside the U.S. government?**

✓ McCarthy relocates the communist threat from foreign armies to the American government itself. His claim is not that the U.S. is losing to a stronger enemy but that it is being betrayed from within by educated, well-placed insiders in the State Department. The rhetorical structure matters: he asserts he holds a list of known communists, but the evidence for the claim is his own assertion of possessing it. Because the charge is framed as secret disloyalty, denial can be read as further proof, which makes the accusation nearly impossible to answer. The effect on society is to make loyalty something citizens must constantly prove.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**McCarthy waves “a list” but never released a verified one, and the number of names changed over time. How should that shape the way a historian weighs this source?**

✓ The immediate audience was a Republican women's club in Wheeling, West Virginia — a minor venue — but the wire services carried it nationally within a day, which is exactly the leverage McCarthy sought. Purpose: political advancement for a first-term senator who needed an issue. Reliability problems are significant: the number of names shifted in later retellings, no verified list was ever produced, and the surviving text of the speech is disputed. That does not reduce the document's value; it changes what it is evidence of. It is excellent evidence of how the Red Scare worked, and poor evidence about actual communists in government.

DOC 7 **Truman on Korea****US.61****ANALYZE****How does Truman justify sending U.S. forces to Korea, and how does he frame the war?**

✓ Truman turns containment into a shooting war. He frames the invasion of South Korea as unprovoked armed aggression that proves communism will now use direct force, not just subversion, and argues that letting it succeed would invite aggression elsewhere. Crucially, he presents the American commitment as support for a United Nations action — collective security rather than a unilateral American war. Strong answers notice the constitutional consequence: by calling it a police action under UN authority, Truman commits large forces to combat without asking Congress for a declaration of war, expanding presidential war-making power for decades afterward.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Truman called Korea a “police action” under the UN rather than asking Congress to declare war. What does that word choice reveal — and what did it change about presidential power?**

✓ The purpose is to legitimize, reassure, and deter simultaneously — reassure the American public, signal allies that commitments are real, and warn Moscow and Beijing. The UN framing does heavy work: it converts an American decision into an international one. Students should note what the language obscures. “Police action” implies restoring order among lawbreakers rather than fighting a war, yet roughly 36,000 Americans would die. Ask them who benefits from that word choice.

DOC 8 The Military-Industrial Complex**US.63****ANALYZE****What does Eisenhower warn the “military-industrial complex” could do to American democracy?**

✓ Eisenhower warns that something genuinely new has appeared in American life: a permanent armaments industry of vast size joined to a large standing military establishment, whereas historically the United States built forces only during wars and dismantled them afterward. His concern is that this combination now touches every city, statehouse, and federal office, and that its economic, political, and even spiritual influence can become unwarranted. He does not call it evil or unnecessary — he insists the defense establishment is required — but he argues that only an alert, knowledgeable citizenry can keep it subordinate to democratic control.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**This warning comes from a war hero and outgoing president who oversaw the very buildup he criticizes. How does his point of view make the warning more powerful — or more complicated?**

✓ The point of view is what gives the warning force. This is a five-star general, the commander of D-Day, and the president who oversaw eight years of the buildup he is describing — the least likely person to be dismissed as soft on defense. The occasion also matters: a farewell address carries no re-election cost, so he can say plainly what a sitting candidate might not. Students should consider the tension: is a warning more credible from an insider, or is an insider's late warning also an evasion of responsibility?

DOC 9 The Cuban Missile Crisis**US.64****ANALYZE****How does Kennedy present the threat and justify the “quarantine” of Cuba?**

✓ Kennedy builds his case in stages: the missiles are offensive rather than defensive, their placement was concealed and accompanied by Soviet assurances that were false, and the threat is sudden and close. Having established deception, he presents the quarantine as the most restrained option available — a step short of invasion or air strikes that stops further weapons without firing. He is explicit that this is only an initial step, keeping escalation visibly in reserve. Strong answers see the dual purpose: the speech is an ultimatum to Khrushchev and a preparation of the American public for the possibility of nuclear war.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Kennedy carefully calls the blockade a “quarantine.” Why would that word choice matter when a blockade is legally an act of war?**

✓ Word choice is the sourcing lesson. A blockade is legally an act of war; a quarantine is not a recognized legal category, and that ambiguity was chosen deliberately to leave room to maneuver. The audience is layered — Americans watching on television, allies who must be held in line, and Moscow, which is really being addressed through the broadcast. What the speech omits is equally telling: American Jupiter missiles already stationed in Turkey and Italy, and the secret deal to remove them that helped end the crisis. Students should ask how the story changes when that omission is restored.

DOC 10 Duck and Cover**US.62****ANALYZE**

What does “Duck and Cover” reveal about how the Cold War reached into everyday American life?

✓ The message teaches children that a nuclear attack is a survivable event that they can prepare for personally — that if they see the flash, the correct response is an immediate, practiced physical action. Its function is as much psychological as physical: by turning annihilation into a classroom drill with a rhyming name and a cartoon turtle, it converts an unmanageable terror into a routine and gives adults something orderly to teach. Students should see that this is what “transformation at home” looks like at the smallest scale — the Cold War reaching into an ordinary elementary school day.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Ducking under a desk offered little real protection from a nuclear blast. Why might the government have promoted these drills anyway?

✓ Audience and purpose are unusually specific: young schoolchildren, reached through their teachers, with federal civil-defense sponsorship behind the production. That sponsorship shapes the content toward calm, order, and confidence, because panic was itself considered a national-security problem. The reliability limit is stark — ducking under a desk offered essentially nothing near a detonation, though it could reduce injury from flying glass and flash burns at distance. So the source is weak evidence about surviving nuclear war and strong evidence about how the government managed public fear.

DOC 11 The Gulf of Tonkin Resolution**US.66****ANALYZE**

How did the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution expand the president's power to wage war?

✓ Congress hands the president open-ended authority to use armed force in Southeast Asia. The critical feature is the breadth of the language: it approves in advance whatever measures the president deems necessary, names no enemy state, sets no troop ceiling, fixes no geographic boundary, and provides no expiration date. There is no declaration of war anywhere in it. Strong answers see the constitutional trade: Congress retains the formal power to declare war but effectively delegates the decision, which allows a major ground war to be fought for years without one.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Congress passed this within days, on disputed reports, by a near-unanimous vote. What does that reveal about the Cold War consensus — and its dangers?

✓ This is a statute, so its evidentiary value differs from a speech: it shows what was legally authorized, not what anyone believed. The circumstances matter enormously — it passed within days, on reports of a second North Vietnamese attack that later evidence indicates did not occur, and it passed 416–0 in the House with only two votes against in the Senate. That near-unanimity is itself the best evidence of the Cold War consensus. Its repeal in 1971 marks how far that consensus had collapsed.

DOC 12 Beyond Vietnam

US.67

ANALYZE

How does King connect the war in Vietnam to injustice and priorities at home?

✓ King argues that the war and the struggle for justice at home cannot be separated. (Paraphrase only — see legal flag above.) His case has several connected parts: the war is draining money and political attention from anti-poverty programs just as those programs were beginning; Black soldiers are dying in disproportionate numbers for liberties they do not fully possess at home; the United States is acting toward the Vietnamese in ways that contradict the values it claims to defend; and a nation that keeps choosing military spending over social spending is approaching moral bankruptcy. He extends this to a broader indictment of racism, materialism, and militarism as linked failures.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

King spoke out knowing it would cost him support from allies and the government. How does that personal risk shape how we weigh his words as a source?

✓ The setting and risk define the source. King speaks at Riverside Church to clergy and laity organized against the war, exactly one year before his assassination, as a Nobel laureate whose authority came from the civil rights movement. Choosing to speak cost him: the Johnson administration turned hostile, major newspapers condemned the speech, and several civil rights leaders publicly distanced themselves for mixing the causes. That is a strong sourcing point — a speaker taking a position against his own coalition's short-term interest is generally speaking from conviction rather than advantage. Students should also weigh the counter-position of critics who argued the movement needed the President's support more than it needed a war stance.

DOC 13 The Silent Majority

US.68

ANALYZE

How does Nixon use the idea of a “silent majority” to build support for his war policy?

✓ Nixon does two things at once. Substantively, he offers Vietnamization: American troops withdraw on a schedule while South Vietnamese forces are trained and equipped to carry the fighting, which promises an exit without the appearance of defeat. Rhetorically, he appeals past the antiwar demonstrators to what he calls the great silent majority of Americans, asking for their support and arguing that North Vietnam cannot defeat the United States — only Americans can do that. Strong answers see how the second move redefines the domestic argument: dissent becomes not a policy disagreement but a threat to the nation's ability to hold together.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Nixon contrasts a quiet “majority” with loud protesters. How is this similar to McCarthy’s tactic (Doc 6) of dividing loyal Americans from disloyal ones?

✓ The purpose is to rebuild domestic support after the enormous Moratorium demonstrations of October 1969, and the timing tells you so. The phrase itself is a rhetorical construction, not a measurement — it asserts that the visible, loud opposition is unrepresentative, while offering no evidence of what the quiet majority actually believed. Students should notice this is the mirror image of McCarthy's move in Doc 6: both define a category of Americans as the real nation and place their opponents outside it.

ANALYZE

How does Reagan use the Berlin Wall itself as an argument against communism?

✓ Reagan uses the Wall itself as the argument. Standing where the physical barrier is visible, he treats it as the concrete evidence that the two systems are not morally equivalent, since only one side had to build a wall to keep its people in. He acknowledges Gorbachev's reforms but sets a test: if liberalization is real, then open the gate and remove the wall. Strong answers see the speech operating on two levels — a direct challenge to a specific leader, and a broader claim that freedom and prosperity in the West had already won the underlying argument.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The wall fell two years after this speech. Why is it risky for a historian to treat Reagan's words as the cause of that event?

✓ The audience is layered and mostly not present. West Berliners are the visible crowd, but the speech is aimed at East Germans listening across the wall, at Moscow, and at American voters in a president's final years. Some of Reagan's own advisers reportedly wanted the challenge line removed as needlessly provocative during delicate arms talks, which tells you it was a deliberate rhetorical choice rather than routine language. The essential caution is post hoc reasoning: the Wall fell in November 1989, but attributing that to this speech ignores Gorbachev's reforms, Soviet economic collapse, Solidarity in Poland, and the East German protest movement.

Model HIPPO Source Analysis

Worked examples for two documents. Use to model sourcing for students.

Doc 6 — McCarthyism (Sen. Joseph McCarthy, Wheeling, WV, 1950)

H — Historical Context	Historical context: February 1950, at the worst possible moment for public confidence. Within the previous six months the Soviets had tested an atomic bomb years earlier than expected, China had fallen to Mao's communists, and Alger Hiss had been convicted of perjury in a case involving espionage allegations. Loyalty review boards created by Truman in 1947 had already established that government employees could be investigated for their beliefs and associations. McCarthy did not create the Red Scare; he supplied a name and a method for a fear already in place.
I — Intended Audience	Intended audience: immediately, the Ohio County Women's Republican Club — a small partisan gathering during Lincoln Day observances. Functionally, the audience was national: McCarthy knew wire services would carry the charge, and the speech reached far beyond the room within a day. The message is pitched at ordinary Americans and aimed against a specific target — Ivy-educated, well-connected State Department officials.
P — Purpose	Purpose: to establish McCarthy as the national voice of anti-communism. He was a first-term senator with a thin record facing re-election in 1952 and looking for an issue. The speech also serves a partisan purpose: it blames twenty years of Democratic administrations for losses abroad by attributing them to internal betrayal rather than to the limits of American power.
P — Point of View	Point of view / bias: a politician making an unverified accusation for advantage. The reliability problems are documented and should be taught directly — the number of alleged communists changed in successive retellings, no verified list was ever produced, McCarthy never proved a single case of espionage, and even the exact text of the Wheeling speech is disputed. This does not make the document useless; it makes it evidence of a different thing. It is first-rate evidence of the mechanics of the Red Scare and poor evidence about actual subversion.
O — Outside Information	Outside information: HUAC and the Hollywood Ten (1947); the Federal Employee Loyalty Program; the Rosenberg case (1951); blacklisting in film, broadcasting, and teaching; the Army-McCarthy hearings (1954), where televised exposure ended his influence; Senate censure in December 1954. Compare the internal-enemy logic here with Nixon's silent-majority framing in Doc 13.

Doc 12 — "Beyond Vietnam" (Rev. Dr. Martin Luther King Jr., 1967)

H — Historical Context	Historical context: April 4, 1967, one year to the day before King's assassination. American troop levels in Vietnam were approaching half a million; the Great Society's antipoverty programs were losing funding to the war; the civil rights movement had won the Civil Rights Act (1964) and Voting Rights Act (1965) but was confronting northern poverty, housing segregation, and the aftermath of the Watts uprising. Draft burdens fell heavily on poor and Black communities.
I — Intended Audience	Intended audience: the Clergy and Laity Concerned About Vietnam gathering at Riverside Church in New York — a religious audience — but through press coverage, the American public, the Johnson administration, and King's own movement. He is speaking to people who trusted his moral authority and were divided about whether he should use it here.
P — Purpose	Purpose: to argue that silence had become betrayal, and to make an explicitly moral and religious case that the war was destroying both Vietnam and America's capacity to address its own injustice. He is not offering a military analysis; he is asking the country to judge the war by the standards it claims for itself.
P — Point of View	Point of view / bias: King is a Baptist minister and Nobel Peace Prize laureate, and the speech is unmistakably a sermon — its authority is prophetic, not technical. The crucial sourcing observation is what it cost him. The Johnson administration turned hostile, major newspapers including the New York Times and Washington Post condemned him, and the NAACP and other allies publicly distanced themselves, fearing the loss of federal support. A speaker who accepts that damage is arguing from conviction rather than advantage — which strengthens the source as evidence of belief, while students should still test his factual claims independently.
O — Outside Information	Outside information: the draft and deferment system; the Great Society and the War on Poverty; Muhammad Ali's 1967 refusal of induction; the Kerner Commission (1968); the Poor People's Campaign; the Tet Offensive (1968) and collapsing public support. Set directly against Doc 13 (Nixon, 1969) to show two competing answers to the same question of who speaks for America.

Model DBQ Response (CER)

THE QUESTION

The Cold War shaped American life for nearly half a century. Using the documents in this packet, evaluate the extent to which the fear of communism transformed both American foreign policy and American society at home.

CLAIM: The fear of communism transformed American foreign policy almost completely and American society at home substantially, though unevenly. Abroad, the change was structural and permanent: between 1947 and 1950 the United States abandoned its peacetime tradition of limited overseas commitment and built a global system of alliances, aid, covert action, and standing military force that outlasted the Soviet Union itself (Docs 1–5, 7). At home the transformation was real but partial — it reshaped politics, employment, schooling, and the boundaries of acceptable speech (Docs 6, 8, 10, 13), yet it never fully overrode constitutional protections or silenced dissent, as the war's critics eventually demonstrated (Docs 8, 12). The deepest change was the arrival of a permanent national-security state that Americans came to accept as normal.

Evidence & Reasoning (foreign policy): The change was rapid and cumulative. Doc 1 (Truman Doctrine, 1947) supplies the organizing principle by dividing the world into two ways of life and committing the United States to support free peoples anywhere — a commitment with no geographic limit and no exit condition. Doc 2 (Marshall Plan) and Doc 5 (Berlin Airlift) show containment executed economically and logistically rather than militarily, which mattered because it demonstrated that the policy could work without war. Doc 3 (Kennan) supplies the intellectual foundation, arguing that Soviet hostility was structural and therefore required patient, long-term counter-pressure rather than negotiation. Doc 4 (NSC-68) then militarizes that logic, treating any communist gain anywhere as a defeat everywhere and calling for a permanent buildup — which removed the ability to rank crises by actual importance. Doc 7 shows the consequence within months: containment becomes a shooting war in Korea, fought under UN authority without a congressional declaration. Doc 11 (Gulf of Tonkin, 1964) completes the pattern by transferring open-ended war authority to the president. Read together, these documents show a foreign policy transformed not just in its goals but in its constitutional mechanics.

Evidence & Reasoning (life at home): The same fear reorganized domestic life. Doc 6 (McCarthy, 1950) shows the threat relocated from foreign armies to American citizens — an accusation structured so that denial itself looked suspicious, which pushed loyalty oaths, blacklists, and firings into government, universities, unions, and entertainment. Doc 10 (Duck and Cover) shows the fear reaching the youngest Americans, converting the possibility of annihilation into a rehearsed classroom routine and making preparedness a normal part of childhood. Doc 8 (Eisenhower, 1961) identifies the structural change: a permanent arms industry joined to a large standing military, historically unprecedented in peacetime, now embedded in the economy of nearly every state — meaning millions of Americans' livelihoods depended on the Cold War continuing. Doc 9 (Kennedy, 1962) shows a president preparing the public for nuclear war on live television. Doc 13 (Nixon, 1969) shows the domestic split the Cold War finally produced, with Americans divided over whether dissent was a right or a danger. Doc 12 (King, 1967) supplies the cost accounting: money and attention promised to the poor went to the war instead.

SOURCING: Two documents show why the evidence must be weighed rather than simply collected. Doc 6 is a partisan speech by a first-term senator seeking a national issue, delivered to a small party club but written for the wire services; no verified list of communists was ever produced, the numbers changed in later retellings, and the text itself is disputed. That unreliability is precisely what makes it useful — it is weak evidence about real subversion and excellent evidence about how accusation without proof could dominate national politics. Doc 8 works the opposite way. Eisenhower is a five-star general and the president who presided over the buildup he is warning against, speaking in a farewell address with no election ahead of him. An insider warning against his own creation, at a moment when he has nothing to gain, is unusually credible testimony that the change was real and permanent.

COMPLEXITY: The transformation was neither total nor purely destructive, and the strongest answers hold both sides. Containment achieved real things — Western Europe recovered under the Marshall Plan (Doc 2), Berlin was supplied without a shot (Doc 5), and a nuclear exchange was avoided in 1962 through restraint as much as resolve (Doc 9). But the same fear that produced those results also produced the ruined careers of Doc 6, the open-ended war authority of Doc 11, and the moral cost King identifies in Doc 12. The pattern that runs through the unit is a recurring exchange of liberty for security, made each time under real threat and rarely reversed afterward. It is also worth noting the limits of the transformation at home: McCarthy fell within four years, the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution was repealed, and the loudest criticisms of the Cold War state came from inside it — from a general in Doc 8 and a minister in Doc 12. American society was bent by the fear of communism far more than it was broken by it, which is why Doc 14 could describe the contest in 1987 as one the West had already won.

Rubric & Scoring Guidance

Criterion	What earns the points
Claim / Thesis (1)	1 pt: a historically defensible claim that responds to BOTH parts of the prompt (foreign policy AND society at home) and establishes a line of reasoning — not merely a restatement of the prompt. Must appear in the introduction or conclusion. The word "extent" should be answered: strong theses qualify (e.g., "almost completely abroad, substantially but unevenly at home"). NOT earning the point: "The Cold War changed America in many ways." "Fear of communism affected foreign policy and society."
Evidence from documents (2)	2 pts: uses the CONTENT of four or more documents to support arguments related to the prompt, and the documents span both halves of the prompt (foreign policy and home front). 1 pt: uses two or three documents accurately, OR describes four+ documents without connecting them to an argument. 0 pts: summarizes documents with no argumentative use, or misrepresents document content. Documents must be cited by number. Simple quoting without explanation does not earn the second point.
Reasoning (1)	1 pt: demonstrates a clear reasoning process — causation (Doc 3's analysis produces Doc 4's buildup, which enables Doc 7's intervention), continuity/change over time (1947 principle to 1964 blank check), or comparison (Doc 6's internal enemy vs. Doc 13's silent majority). The reasoning must be developed across the response, not asserted once. Explaining WHY a document supports the claim is the key behavior.
Sourcing / HIPPO (1)	1 pt: for at least ONE document (two is stronger), explains how historical context, intended audience, purpose, or point of view is RELEVANT to the argument. The explanation must go beyond identification. NOT earning the point: "McCarthy was a senator, so he was biased." EARNING the point: "Because McCarthy was a first-term senator seeking a national issue and never produced the list, the speech is weak evidence of actual subversion but strong evidence of how accusation alone could reshape politics."
Complexity (1)	1 pt: demonstrates complex understanding by qualifying the argument with evidence — e.g., acknowledging containment's genuine successes alongside its domestic costs, noting that the transformation at home was reversible (McCarthy's fall, Tonkin's repeal) while the foreign-policy transformation was not, or explaining the recurring security-vs-liberty exchange as a pattern rather than a single event. Must be substantiated with document or outside evidence, not asserted in a single sentence. This is the point students earn least often; award it only for sustained, evidenced nuance.

★ U.S. HISTORY HACK™

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UNIT 8



Postwar America

1945-1963 • US.71-US.77

— ★ —
TROOPTOTEACHER TECHNOLOGIES LLC

DBQ Answer Key & Scoring Guide

A Nation in Transition (1950s–1963)
Standards US.71 – US.77

Teacher-facing document. Model answers are strong exemplars to guide scoring — not the only acceptable responses. Accept any answer that is accurate and well-supported by the documents.

Document Answer Notes

DOC 1 The GI Bill and the Postwar Boom

US.71

ANALYZE

How did the GI Bill help build the postwar middle class?

✓ The GI Bill turned military service into a ladder into the middle class. It paid tuition, which let a generation become the first in their families to attend college, and it backed low-down-payment home loans, which let ordinary wage-earners become homeowners. Strong answers see the multiplier: a degree meant a better job, a house meant equity and a stake in the community, and millions of families doing this at once created a broad new middle class and fueled the consumer boom (cars, appliances, televisions). The prosperity was not automatic — it was built by a deliberate federal program.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The speaker notes a Black veteran “could not get the same loan or into the same school.” How does that complicate the story of postwar prosperity as a shared national experience?

✓ The speaker’s aside about a Black veteran who “could not get the same loan or into the same school” is the key. Southern colleges excluded Black students, and banks — backed by federal lending rules — routinely refused loans in Black neighborhoods (redlining). So the same program that built the white middle class often bypassed Black veterans with identical service, meaning the postwar boom widened the racial wealth gap even as it lifted millions. Students should conclude that “shared national prosperity” was real but selectively distributed by policy, not by merit.

DOC 2 Moving to the Suburbs

US.72

ANALYZE

What does this account reveal about both the appeal and the exclusion of postwar suburbs?

✓ The suburbs delivered a real version of the American Dream — mass-production made single-family homeownership cheaper than city renting, and young families got yards, new schools, and a pool. But the same account documents the exclusion built into that dream: developers refused to sell to Black families and wrote it into the contracts. Strong answers hold both at once — the suburb was simultaneously an engine of upward mobility and an engine of segregation, and the two were not separate features but parts of the same system.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The speaker says “it took me years to understand.” How can a firsthand memory reveal something the person did not fully see at the time?

✓ The line “it took me years to understand” is a sourcing gift. A firsthand account is powerful because the speaker lived it, but it is also limited because people rarely see the full structure of their own world. At the time, the covenant felt normal and invisible; only later did the speaker recognize the “fence you couldn’t see.” That gap between experience and understanding is exactly what makes memory valuable and tricky at once — it captures how ordinary people normalized segregation without feeling like participants in it.

DOC 3 The Interstate Highway Act

US.72

ANALYZE

How did the Interstate Highway Act reshape where and how Americans lived?

✓ The interstates rewired daily life around the automobile. By making fast car travel possible over long distances, the highways accelerated the flight to the suburbs (workers could live far from where they worked), created the commuter lifestyle, and spawned the motels, drive-ins, and shopping centers that clustered around exits. Strong answers also see the losers: money poured into roads and cars while streetcars and passenger rail withered, and highways routed through cities often destroyed established — frequently Black — neighborhoods.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The law leans on “national defense” to justify the highways. How does that Cold War framing help explain why such an enormous project won support?

✓ Calling the highways “national defense” (evacuation, troop movement, atomic attack) attached the project to the era’s overriding priority, which is why it won such broad and lasting support and funding. A domestic public-works program of that scale might have faced resistance; a Cold War necessity did not. Students should notice the pattern from the whole unit — labeling a domestic goal a security need was a reliable way to unlock federal money and unity in these years.

DOC 4 Television Comes Home**US.73****ANALYZE****How did television shape both American culture and consumer spending in the 1950s?**

✓ Television manufactured a shared national culture — the same programs, jokes, ballgames, and commercials reaching millions simultaneously — and in doing so became the most powerful selling machine ever built. The account ties culture and consumption together: TV did not just entertain, it taught families that belonging meant buying what everyone else bought, standardizing desire across the country. Strong answers connect this to conformity, the decade's pressure to look, live, and consume like everyone else.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**This is a personal memory, not a company's advertisement. How might that everyday viewpoint reveal an effect of television that an advertiser would not admit?**

✓ Because this is a viewer's memory rather than a sponsor's pitch, it can admit what advertising never would: that the point was to make people "want the same things," and that being a "good American family" got quietly redefined as a shopping identity. An advertiser's own materials would frame this as free choice and abundance; the everyday viewpoint exposes the manufactured, repetitive pressure ("over and over until we could sing the jingles") behind that abundance.

DOC 5 The Feminine Mystique**US.76****ANALYZE****What discontent beneath 1950s prosperity does Friedan expose?**

✓ Friedan exposes the discontent hidden inside the era's ideal of the happy suburban housewife. Beneath the prosperity, many educated women felt a quiet, nameless dissatisfaction — "Is this all?" — because a culture that told them to find total fulfillment in home and family left their talents and ambitions unused. Strong answers see that this is a critique of the prosperity itself: material comfort did not equal fulfillment, and the "feminine mystique" was a cage as much as a comfort.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Friedan wrote mainly about educated, middle-class white housewives. How might that focus limit whose experience her book represents?**

✓ Friedan wrote about a specific population — college-educated, middle-class, largely white suburban wives who had the option of not working. That focus limits the book: poor women and many women of color had always worked outside the home out of necessity, so "Is this all?" did not describe their central problem. The source is strong evidence of one important experience and weak evidence for a universal female experience — a distinction students should make explicitly.

DOC 6 The Other America**US.71****ANALYZE**

How does Harrington challenge the image of the 1950s and early 1960s as universally prosperous?

✓ Harrington shatters the image of universal prosperity by insisting on a second, hidden nation of 40 to 50 million poor people living inside the affluent one. His argument is not just that poverty existed but that it had become invisible — pushed into Appalachia, aging inner cities, and rural corners the suburban, televised America never saw. Strong answers use this to directly complicate the DBQ's "prosperity and unity": the boom was real, but so was mass poverty, and the two coexisted.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Harrington says this poverty was “hidden.” Why might poverty have been easier to ignore in an age of suburbs, highways, and television?

✓ The word "hidden" is the analytical hinge. Suburbanization physically separated the comfortable from the poor; the interstates let the middle class drive past poverty without entering it; and television advertised abundance, not want. Prosperity, in other words, built its own blinders. Poverty was easier to ignore precisely because the machinery of the era — suburbs, cars, TV — sorted Americans into worlds that rarely overlapped.

DOC 7 Brown v. Board of Education**US.75****ANALYZE**

On what grounds does the Court rule that segregated schools are unconstitutional?

✓ The Court rules that segregated schooling is unconstitutional because it violates the guarantee of equal protection, and it does so on a specific ground: separation "solely because of race" is itself a harm, regardless of whether buildings and books are equal. That reasoning directly overturns "separate but equal" from Plessy. Strong answers note the unanimity and the sweep — "inherently unequal" leaves no room for segregation to be fixed by equalizing facilities.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The Court says segregation harms children’s “hearts and minds.” How does resting the ruling on psychological harm, not just unequal buildings, strengthen it?

✓ By resting the decision on psychological harm — the "feeling of inferiority" that damages "hearts and minds" — the Court removed segregation's central legal defense. Under Plessy, a state could claim equality by matching facilities; Brown made that impossible, because the injury is the separation itself, which no amount of equal funding can cure. Grounding the ruling in harm to children also gave it moral force beyond the legal technicality, though it left the harder question of enforcement unanswered.

DOC 8 The Montgomery Bus Boycott

US.75

ANALYZE**What does this account reveal about the methods and spirit of the Montgomery Bus Boycott?**

✓ The account shows the movement's method and spirit: a sustained, disciplined, nonviolent economic boycott. Ordinary people withheld their bus fares and walked for over a year, absorbing threats, arrests, and bombings without striking back. Strong answers see the strategy inside the endurance — nonviolence was not passivity but a deliberate tactic that turned suffering into moral leverage, and collective sacrifice ("we just kept walking") into power that a single protester could never have.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**The speaker says "our feet were tired but our souls were rested." How does that firsthand voice capture something a court ruling cannot?**

✓ "Our feet were tired but our souls were rested" conveys something no court ruling can — the inner experience of the participants: the dignity, faith, and sense of liberation that made a year of hardship bearable. A legal document records the outcome; the firsthand voice records the meaning and emotional cost, and explains why people kept walking. That is exactly the value of testimony as a source, and also its limit — it is one person's remembered feeling, shaped by pride and hindsight.

DOC 9 The Crisis at Little Rock

US.75

ANALYZE**How does Eisenhower justify using federal troops against a state's resistance to integration?**

✓ Eisenhower justifies sending troops not primarily as a defense of the nine students but as a defense of federal authority and the rule of law: a state's "mob rule" cannot be allowed to nullify a federal court order, and the President's duty to enforce that order is "inescapable." Strong answers see him framing the crisis as a constitutional question of federal power versus state defiance, which let a cautious president act decisively without staking everything on the morality of integration itself.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Eisenhower stresses "mob rule" and court orders more than the rights of the students themselves. What might that emphasis reveal about how he chose to justify acting?**

✓ Eisenhower foregrounds law, order, and courts far more than the rights or humanity of the Black students. That emphasis reveals his caution — he was personally lukewarm on Brown and worried about Southern backlash, so he anchored his action in the safest possible ground (enforcing a court order and preventing anarchy) rather than in a moral endorsement of civil rights. Students should see that the framing was itself a political choice, and contrast it with Kennedy's explicitly moral framing in Doc 14.

DOC 10 We Choose to Go to the Moon**US.74****ANALYZE****How does Kennedy use the goal of reaching the Moon to inspire the nation?**

✓ Kennedy inspires by casting the Moon landing as a hard goal chosen precisely because it is hard — a challenge that will "organize and measure the best of our energies and skills." He frames space as a new frontier of knowledge and progress "for all people," turning an expensive, risky program into a test of national character and ambition. Strong answers see the appeal to unity and purpose: a shared, difficult mission gave the prosperous nation something collective to strive for.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Kennedy says the U.S. must lead in space so it is not "governed by a hostile flag." How does the Cold War shape even this hopeful vision of exploration?**

✓ The soaring rhetoric is stitched to Cold War fear. Kennedy vows space will not be "governed by a hostile flag of conquest," which reveals the real driver — the U.S. was reacting to Soviet space firsts (Sputnik) and could not afford to look second-best. Even this hopeful vision of exploration is a front in the superpower contest, which is why a government would spend billions on it. Prestige and containment, not just curiosity, funded the Moon.

DOC 11 The Kennedy Inaugural**US.77****ANALYZE****How does Kennedy try to inspire a spirit of service and sacrifice in Americans?**

✓ Kennedy inspires service by redefining citizenship as duty rather than benefit — "ask not what your country can do for you." He tells Americans the torch has passed to their generation, raising the stakes so ordinary people feel personally responsible for the nation's ideals, and he links that call to a global mission of freedom. Strong answers see how the speech converts Cold War anxiety into idealistic energy — the same fear that built bombs is channeled into the Peace Corps and public service.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Kennedy promises to "pay any price, bear any burden" for liberty. How might that Cold War pledge later help draw the U.S. deeper into conflicts like Vietnam?**

✓ "Pay any price, bear any burden... oppose any foe" is an open-ended, unlimited commitment. Its very grandeur set a trap: if the United States pledged to defend liberty everywhere at any cost, then backing down from any Cold War commitment could be framed as betraying that pledge. Students should connect this to Vietnam — the credibility logic that made a small, distant war feel like a test of the whole promise, and made withdrawal feel impossible.

DOC 12 **Rock 'n' Roll and the Youth Culture****US.73****ANALYZE****How did 1950s youth culture challenge the conformity and rules of the adult world?**

✓ Youth culture challenged the adult world by carving out a separate identity the older generation neither controlled nor approved of. Teenagers had their own money, music, movies, and styles, and they used them to reject being "smaller copies of our parents." Strong answers see the substance beneath the noise — rock 'n' roll's loudness and rebellion were a rejection of 1950s conformity, and the generation gap it opened foreshadowed the larger youth revolts of the 1960s.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**The speaker says adults could not stand that “white kids and Black kids were listening to the same songs.” How could popular music quietly cross lines that laws still enforced?**

✓ Rock 'n' roll drew directly from Black rhythm and blues, and when white and Black teenagers listened and danced to the same music, they were crossing a color line that schools, buses, and neighborhoods still enforced by law. Culture moved faster than law: shared music created shared experience and eroded the sense that segregation was natural, quietly doing integrating work that courts were still fighting to compel. That is why adults found the mixing, not just the volume, threatening.

DOC 13 **Silent Spring****US.74****ANALYZE****How does Carson use the image of a “silent spring” to warn Americans about pollution?**

✓ Carson warns by turning an ecological argument into a haunting image — a town where pesticides have killed the birds, so spring arrives "without voices." The silence stands for a poisoned, broken natural world, and the fable implies that what happened to this imagined town could happen anywhere DDT and chemicals were used carelessly. Strong answers see that she reframes prosperity's cost: the same postwar science and industry that produced abundance were also quietly damaging the living world.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Carson begins with an imagined “fable” rather than data. Why might a vivid story reach readers in a way that scientific statistics might not?**

✓ A fable reaches readers emotionally and morally in a way a table of toxicity data cannot. By making people feel the loss of birdsong — something ordinary and beloved — Carson gave an abstract, invisible danger a vivid human stake, so readers cared before they were asked to weigh evidence. Students should note the trade-off: the story built public alarm and a movement, but its power came from imagery, so the scientific claims still had to stand up separately (as Carson's later chapters argued they did).

ANALYZE

How does Kennedy frame civil rights as a moral, not just legal, question?

✓ Kennedy reframes civil rights from a legal or regional dispute into "primarily a moral issue" — a matter of right and wrong "as old as the Scriptures." By asking whether Americans will treat others "as we want to be treated," he makes segregation a betrayal of the nation's core values, not merely a violation of a statute. Strong answers see the shift in responsibility: a moral framing implicates every citizen and the whole nation, not just Southern officials or the courts.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Kennedy points to "one hundred years of delay" since Lincoln. How does linking civil rights to emancipation strengthen his call to act?

✓ Invoking "one hundred years of delay" since Lincoln freed the slaves ties the demand for civil rights to the nation's most sacred unfinished promise. It reframes action as overdue debt rather than new favor — the country already committed to freedom in 1863 and has failed to deliver for a century. That lineage raises the moral pressure and denies opponents the claim that this is a radical new demand; it is, Kennedy argues, the completion of emancipation.

Model HIPPO Source Analysis

Worked examples for two documents. Use to model sourcing for students.

Doc 6 — The Other America (Michael Harrington, 1962)

H — Historical Context	Historical context: published at the height of postwar affluence and near the end of the "consensus" era, just as Kennedy's advisers were beginning to study poverty. Suburbanization, television, and the interstates had physically and psychologically separated the comfortable majority from the poor, making Harrington's central claim — that poverty was hidden — newly plausible.
I — Intended Audience	Intended audience: the educated, prosperous middle-class reading public — precisely the people least likely to see poverty in their daily lives. Harrington wanted to make the comfortable uncomfortable, so the book is pitched to readers who assumed the boom was universal.
P — Purpose	Purpose: to make invisible poverty visible and to demand action. This is advocacy, not neutral reporting — Harrington is building a moral and political case, and the book directly influenced the Kennedy and Johnson antipoverty programs (the War on Poverty).
P — Point of View	Point of view / bias: Harrington was a democratic socialist and activist, so he foregrounds structural causes and the scale of the problem, and his figures (40–50 million) are estimates marshaled to persuade. That commitment is a strength for understanding the critique and a caution for taking the numbers as precise — students should treat it as a powerful argument, corroborated by later data, rather than a neutral census.
O — Outside Information	Outside information: the War on Poverty, the Economic Opportunity Act (1964), Appalachia, urban renewal, redlining and the racial wealth gap (Doc 1), and the general "affluent society" thesis the book was written to rebut.

Doc 9 — The Crisis at Little Rock (President Eisenhower, 1957)

H — Historical Context	Historical context: September 1957, three years after Brown (Doc 7), amid "massive resistance" across the South. Arkansas Governor Orval Faubus had used the National Guard to block nine Black students from Central High, creating a direct challenge to federal court authority broadcast on national television.
I — Intended Audience	Intended audience: the entire nation, but especially the white South (to justify federal force and warn against defiance) and international observers, since Cold War rivals used American segregation as propaganda.
P — Purpose	Purpose: to justify sending federal troops while calming a tense nation. Eisenhower needed to appear firm on the rule of law without inflaming Southern whites more than necessary, so the speech is carefully framed around order and constitutional duty.
P — Point of View	Point of view / bias: Eisenhower was personally cautious about civil rights and reluctant to intervene; he acted to defend federal authority against "mob rule," not to champion integration. That is why the address emphasizes courts, law, and order far more than the students' rights — a revealing choice that shows how even decisive federal action could be framed to avoid a moral endorsement of the movement.
O — Outside Information	Outside information: Brown v. Board (1954), the Little Rock Nine, Governor Faubus, "massive resistance," the 101st Airborne, and the contrast with Kennedy's explicitly moral framing six years later (Doc 14).

Model DBQ Response (CER)

THE QUESTION

The years from the 1950s to the early 1960s are often remembered as an age of prosperity and consensus. Using the documents in this packet, evaluate the extent to which postwar American life lived up to its image of prosperity and unity.

CLAIM: Postwar America's image of prosperity and unity was genuinely real for millions — but it was neither universal nor as harmonious as it looked, and the strongest answer holds both truths at once. A deliberate federal boom lifted a broad new middle class into homes, cars, and college (Docs 1–4, 10–11), yet that prosperity was quietly unsatisfying to some (Docs 5, 12–13), invisible to the tens of millions it never reached (Doc 6), and built on the deliberate exclusion of Black Americans that the early civil rights movement had just begun to challenge (Docs 7–9, 14). The era was a golden age and an age of hidden discontent and struggle simultaneously.

Evidence & Reasoning (the prosperity was real): The boom was not a myth. The GI Bill turned service into college degrees and home loans, manufacturing a middle class almost overnight (Doc 1); mass-produced suburbs made homeownership cheaper than renting (Doc 2); the Interstate Highway Act rebuilt daily life around the car and the commute (Doc 3); and television created a shared national culture of abundance (Doc 4). Kennedy's New Frontier captured the era's confidence, channeling it into the Moon program (Doc 10) and a call to national service (Doc 11). Together these show a society that really had grown richer, more mobile, and more unified in its common culture than ever before.

Evidence & Reasoning (the image was incomplete): The same documents, read closely, expose the limits. Friedan named the quiet dissatisfaction of women boxed into the housewife ideal (Doc 5); the new youth culture rejected the conformity the era prized (Doc 12); and Carson revealed that postwar science was poisoning the natural world (Doc 13). Harrington shattered the picture of universal wealth by counting 40–50 million poor hidden inside the affluent nation (Doc 6). And the deepest exclusion was racial: Brown declared segregated schools inherently unequal (Doc 7), Montgomery's boycotters walked for a year to be treated as human beings (Doc 8), Little Rock required federal troops against a defiant state (Doc 9), and Kennedy finally admitted that a century after emancipation Black Americans were "not yet freed from the bonds of injustice" (Doc 14).

SOURCING: Two sources show why the "prosperity and unity" image must be tested, not taken at face value. Harrington's *The Other America* (Doc 6) is openly persuasive advocacy by a socialist writer, pitched at the comfortable readers least likely to see poverty; its very purpose was to prove the consensus image false, so it is strong evidence that prosperity was selective even if its figures are estimates. Eisenhower's Little Rock address (Doc 9) reveals the opposite pressure: a reluctant president framed federal action around "mob rule" and court orders rather than the students' rights, showing that even enforcing integration was done cautiously, to preserve authority, not to endorse the movement.

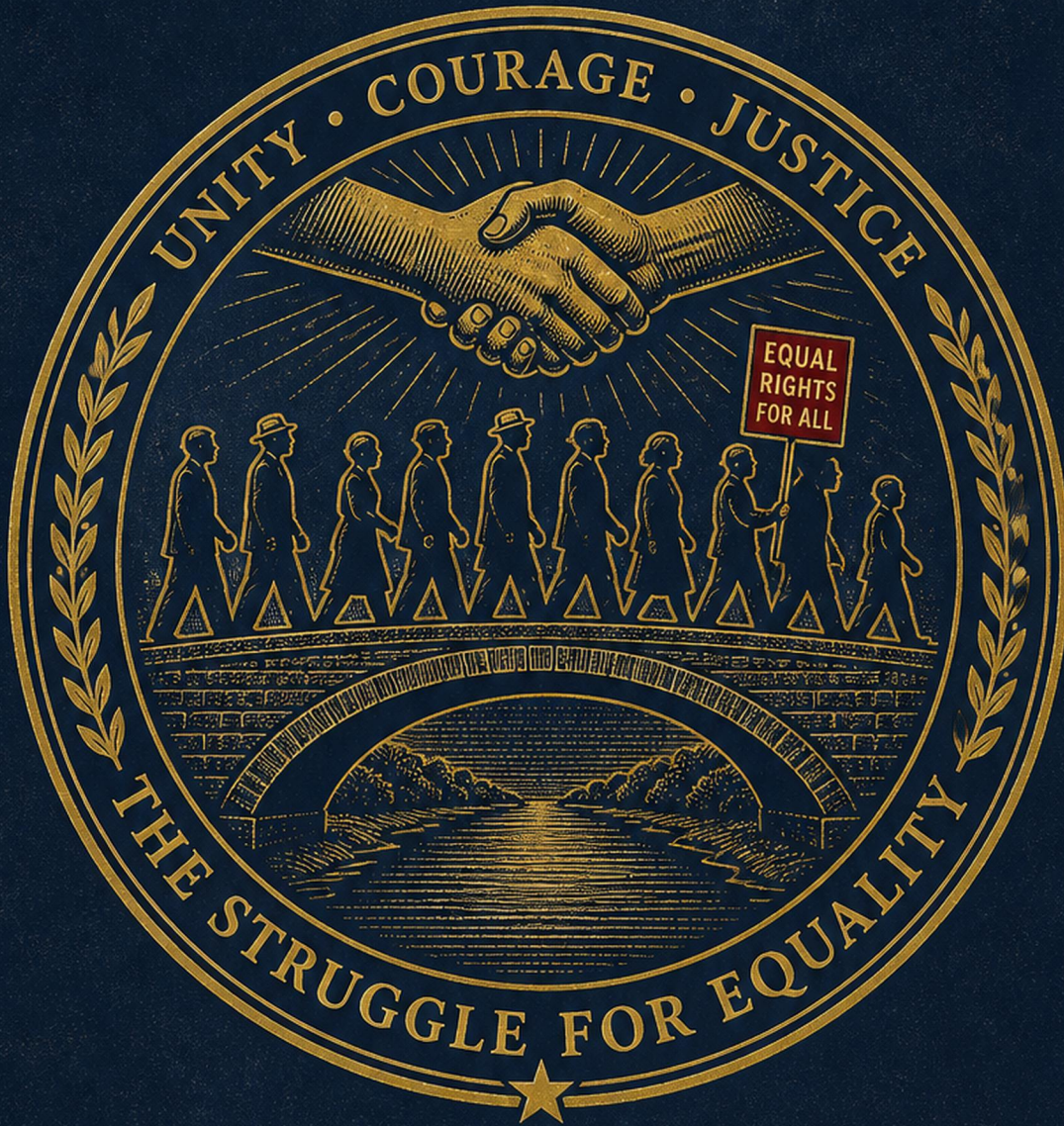
COMPLEXITY: The most sophisticated understanding recognizes that prosperity and its limits were not separate stories but the same one. The suburb that fulfilled the American Dream (Doc 2) was segregated by covenant in the same breath; the GI Bill that built the white middle class (Doc 1) bypassed Black veterans and widened the racial wealth gap; the interstates and television that unified the nation (Docs 3–4) also let the comfortable drive and watch right past the poverty of Doc 6. The era's optimism (Docs 10–11) and its "one hundred years of delay" (Doc 14) coexisted in the same years. Postwar America therefore lived up to its image substantially but selectively — a real golden age for those included, and precisely for that reason a period whose exclusions and discontents were about to erupt into the movements of the later 1960s.

Rubric & Scoring Guidance

Criterion	What earns the points
Claim / Thesis (1)	1 pt: a historically defensible claim that answers the "extent" question by qualifying it — e.g., "prosperity was real but selective and not truly unified." Must take a position and preview a line of reasoning, in the introduction or conclusion. NOT earning the point: "The 1950s were a time of great change." A simple restatement of the prompt does not qualify.
Evidence from documents (2)	2 pts: uses the CONTENT of four or more documents accurately to support the argument, drawing on BOTH the prosperity documents and the limits/exclusion documents. 1 pt: two–three documents, or four+ merely described without argumentative use. Documents must be cited by number; quoting without explanation does not earn the second point.
Reasoning (1)	1 pt: shows a clear reasoning process — causation (the GI Bill and highways CAUSE suburban growth), comparison (Eisenhower's legal framing vs. Kennedy's moral framing), or continuity/change (early civil rights victories building toward the 1960s). The reasoning must be developed, not asserted once. Explaining WHY a document supports the claim is the key behavior.
Sourcing / HIPPO (1)	1 pt: for at least one document (two is stronger), explains how context, audience, purpose, or point of view is RELEVANT to the argument, beyond identification. NOT earning: "Harrington was biased." EARNING: "Because Harrington wrote as an advocate aiming at comfortable readers, the book is strong evidence that prosperity was selective, even if its numbers are estimates." Reconstructed voices (Docs 1, 2, 8, 12) can be sourced by discussing what a typical firsthand memory reveals and what it may miss.
Complexity (1)	1 pt: demonstrates complex understanding with evidence — e.g., showing that prosperity and exclusion were the same system (the segregated suburb, the bypassed Black veteran), that the era was a golden age and an age of discontent at once, or that its very successes hid its poverty. Must be substantiated, not asserted in one sentence. This point is earned least often; award only for sustained, evidenced nuance.

U.S. HISTORY HACK™

UNIT 9



The Civil Rights Movement

1954–1975 • US.78–US.82

TROOPTOTEACHER TECHNOLOGIES LLC

DBQ Answer Key & Scoring Guide

The Civil Rights Movement (1950s–1960s)
Standards US.78 – US.82

Teacher-facing document. Model answers are strong exemplars to guide scoring — not the only acceptable responses. Accept any answer that is accurate and well-supported by the documents.

Document Answer Notes

DOC 1 The Greensboro Sit-Ins

US.78

ANALYZE

How did the sit-in use nonviolence to challenge segregation?

✓ The sit-in weaponized nonviolence by putting quiet, disciplined dignity against loud, ugly violence. The students did something legally simple — sat and asked to be served — but by refusing to leave and refusing to fight back while being abused, they forced the community to choose between serving them and revealing its cruelty in public. Strong answers see the strategy: the protest was designed to be morally unanswerable and easily copied, which is why four students became a regional wave within weeks.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The students “trained themselves not to strike back.” Why was that discipline central to the power of nonviolent protest?

✓ The discipline of not striking back was the whole engine. If the students had fought, the story becomes “a brawl,” and the public can dismiss both sides; because they only absorbed the violence, the moral contrast was total and the aggressors had no cover. Nonviolence also made the movement infinitely reproducible — anyone could sit quietly — and it denied segregationists the excuse of “restoring order.” The restraint was not weakness; it was the source of the leverage.

DOC 2 The Freedom Rides

US.78

ANALYZE

How did the Freedom Riders use the nation’s attention to force federal action?

✓ The Freedom Riders turned the nation's attention into a lever against a federal government that was reluctant to act. By deliberately testing a desegregation ruling the government was not enforcing, they created a crisis it could not ignore: either Washington protected citizens exercising a legal right, or it visibly allowed mobs to firebomb buses. Strong answers see that the riders' courage was strategic — they went where the violence would be worst precisely because that violence, once seen, would force a response.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

The riders wanted the violence shown “on television.” How did media coverage become a weapon of the movement?

✓ Wanting the beatings shown “on television” reveals how central media had become. Segregation survived partly by being invisible to the rest of the country, framed as a settled local custom; televised images of mob violence against peaceful, well-dressed riders exposed it as organized brutality against Americans. The camera turned distant Northern sympathy into political pressure, and it made federal inaction look like complicity — which is why media coverage functioned as a weapon the movement deliberately used.

DOC 3 Letter from Birmingham Jail**US.79****ANALYZE****How does King defend the movement's refusal to wait any longer for equality?**

✓ King defends the refusal to wait by attacking the logic of "wait" itself. (Paraphrase only — see legal note.) He argues that "injustice anywhere is a threat to justice everywhere," so the crisis in Birmingham is not a local matter that outsiders should stay out of, and that the call for patience — "Wait" — has, across centuries, always meant "Never." After more than three hundred years, he says, more delay is not moderation but a way of preserving injustice. Strong answers see him reframing nonviolent protest as the responsible alternative to both passive acceptance and violence.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**King wrote this from a jail cell to fellow clergy who had urged patience. How does knowing that audience shape the letter's argument?**

✓ The audience is everything. King is answering white clergymen who had called his protests "untimely," so the letter is aimed not at hardened racists but at sympathetic moderates who preferred order to conflict. That is why he spends his fire on the "white moderate" and the word "wait" rather than on segregationists — he is trying to move the people who thought they were already on his side but kept counseling delay. Knowing the audience explains the letter's patient, reasoned, but relentless tone.

DOC 4 I Have a Dream**US.79****ANALYZE****What vision of America does King offer in this speech?**

✓ King offers a vision of America redeemed by its own stated ideals — a nation where his children are "judged not by the color of their skin but by the content of their character." (Paraphrase only.) Rather than describing grievances, he describes a future, tying the movement's demands to the country's deepest promises of equality and brotherhood. Strong answers see the strategic optimism: by framing civil rights as the fulfillment of the American dream rather than a threat to it, King invites the whole nation to join rather than resist.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**King spoke to a quarter-million people and a national television audience. How did the March on Washington turn a dream into political pressure?**

✓ The March on Washington converted a dream into pressure by demonstrating scale, discipline, and breadth: a quarter-million peaceful people, Black and white, on national television, at the seat of government, made the demand for a civil rights bill impossible to portray as fringe or dangerous. The size showed political power; the peacefulness showed moral authority; the setting aimed both directly at Congress and the president. The speech's hope was the honey, but the march itself was the leverage.

DOC 5 The Civil Rights Act of 1964**US.80****ANALYZE****How did the Civil Rights Act of 1964 change the law on segregation and discrimination?**

✓ The Civil Rights Act attacked segregation and discrimination in the two arenas that shaped daily life: public accommodations (restaurants, hotels, theaters) and employment. By banning discrimination "on the ground of race, color, religion, or national origin" — and, in employment, sex — it made the everyday humiliations of segregation illegal nationwide and gave the federal government tools to enforce the ban. Strong answers see the magnitude: this ended legal Jim Crow in public life, the single largest legislative achievement of the movement.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**This law was won only after years of protest, violence, and a president's assassination. How does that context help explain why it reached so far?**

✓ The years of protest, televised violence, and Kennedy's assassination created the political conditions that let the law go so far. Birmingham and the March on Washington (Docs 3–4) had built overwhelming moral pressure; Kennedy's death let Johnson frame the bill as a martyred president's legacy; and the sheer scale of demonstrations made inaction politically costly. The law reached as far as it did because protest had already shifted public opinion and made the status quo untenable — evidence that nonviolent pressure and federal action worked together.

DOC 6 The Ballot or the Bullet**US.79****ANALYZE****How does Malcolm X's approach differ from King's nonviolence (Docs 3–4)?**

✓ Malcolm X rejects the premise that suffering must be endured patiently. (Paraphrase only.) Where King urges love and nonviolence toward attackers, Malcolm X frames the choice as "the ballot or the bullet" and insists on the right of self-defense — he will be nonviolent only with those who are nonviolent with him. His approach emphasizes Black self-reliance, dignity, and power rather than appealing to white conscience for acceptance. Strong answers see the core difference: King sought to win over the majority; Malcolm X sought to build independent Black strength and warned that denied justice would bring violence.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Malcolm X and King are often set against each other. How might their different approaches have actually strengthened the movement when taken together?**

✓ Set against each other, the two men may have reinforced each other's effectiveness. Malcolm X's militancy made King's nonviolence look like the safer, more reasonable option to white moderates and officials — the "or else" that made compromise attractive. Meanwhile King's mass movement gave Malcolm X's warnings their urgency. Students can argue that the threat of the "bullet" helped make the "ballot" (and the Civil Rights and Voting Rights Acts) more appealing to those in power, so the two wings pressured the country from different directions at once.

DOC 7 We Shall Overcome**US.80****ANALYZE****How does Johnson frame voting rights as an American cause, not just a Black cause?**

✓ Johnson nationalizes the cause. By placing Selma alongside Lexington, Concord, and Appomattox, he casts the voting-rights struggle as a chapter in America's own founding story of freedom, not a regional or racial dispute. His insistence that there is "only an American problem" tells white Americans that this is their fight too, and his closing "we shall overcome" adopts the movement's own anthem from the presidency itself. Strong answers see the strategic power: the federal government is no longer a reluctant referee but a declared ally.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**A Southern president embracing "we shall overcome" was stunning. How does his point of view give the speech special weight?**

✓ Point of view gives the speech extraordinary weight. Johnson was a Southerner and a career deal-maker, not a movement radical; for such a president to speak the movement's sacred words on national television signaled that the highest power in the country had committed itself, which reassured moderates and isolated segregationists. Coming days after Selma (Doc 9), it also shows the mechanism of the movement — nonviolent protest created the moral crisis, and a Southern president's response converted it into federal law (Doc 8).

DOC 8 The Voting Rights Act of 1965**US.80****ANALYZE****How did the Voting Rights Act of 1965 change who could vote in the South?**

✓ The Voting Rights Act attacked the machinery of disfranchisement directly: it banned the "tests or devices" (literacy tests and similar tricks) that Southern states had used to keep Black citizens off the rolls, and — crucially — authorized federal examiners to register voters where states had blocked them. That enforcement provision is what made it work: it did not just declare a right, it sent the federal government in to guarantee it. Strong answers see the result — a transformation of Southern politics as Black registration surged.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**This law let the federal government directly register voters. Why was such strong federal action needed to secure a right that already existed on paper?**

✓ The Fifteenth Amendment had guaranteed the right to vote regardless of race since 1870, yet for almost a century Southern states nullified it with literacy tests, poll taxes, and intimidation. A paper right meant nothing without enforcement, so the Act had to authorize federal officials to physically register voters and oversee elections. That necessity shows how deeply resistance was entrenched — and why only direct federal power, prompted by the protests at Selma, could finally deliver a right that had existed in the Constitution for ninety-five years.

DOC 9 **Bloody Sunday at Selma****US.80****ANALYZE****How did the events at Selma help bring about the Voting Rights Act?**

✓ Selma shows the movement's core mechanism in its clearest form: disciplined nonviolent marchers, demanding an obviously just right, met with brutal official violence in front of cameras. The marchers "carried nothing but their shoes and their courage," so when troopers clubbed and gassed them, there was no ambiguity — the whole nation watched lawmen attack peaceful citizens praying for the vote. Strong answers see how that moral clarity produced results: national outrage, an influx of supporters of every race, and, within months, the Voting Rights Act.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**The marcher says “the whole country saw it that night on television.” How did televised violence turn a local march into national change?**

✓ Television is what scaled Selma from a local march to national law. Seen live, the violence could not be dismissed as a rumor or a two-sided clash; it entered living rooms as a clear moral fact, and it made ordinary Americans feel implicated. That pressure moved Congress and the president (Doc 7) far faster than years of quiet petitioning had. The lesson — that visible, televised suffering by nonviolent protesters could force federal action — is the strongest single piece of evidence for the DBQ's claim about nonviolence.

DOC 10 **Black Power****US.81****ANALYZE****What frustration with the nonviolent movement does the call for “Black Power” express?**

✓ The call for "Black Power" expresses exhaustion with the nonviolent, integrationist strategy. (Paraphrase only.) After six years of marches, beatings, and slow change, Carmichael argues that appealing to white conscience has produced too little, and that Black Americans should stop asking and instead build their own political and economic power and control their own communities. Strong answers see it as both a critique and a redirection — a shift from "freedom now" won through moral appeal to "power now" built through self-reliance.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**“Black Power” inspired many younger activists but alarmed many white Americans and some older leaders. Why might the same slogan do both?**

✓ The same slogan could inspire and frighten because it meant different things to different listeners. To many young Black activists worn down by violence, "Black Power" meant pride, dignity, and self-determination — an end to begging. To many white Americans and some older civil rights leaders, the word "power" (paired with a rejection of nonviolence) sounded like a threat of retaliation and separatism, which frightened them and, some feared, endangered the coalition that had passed the civil rights laws. The ambiguity of the phrase was exactly its power and its risk.

DOC 11 The Kerner Report**US.81****ANALYZE****How does the Kerner Commission explain the causes of urban unrest?**

✓ The Kerner Commission locates the cause of the urban riots not in agitators or criminals but in white racism and the poverty and segregation it produced. Its famous warning — the nation is "moving toward two societies, one black, one white — separate and unequal" — reframes the unrest as the predictable result of ghettos that "white institutions created... maintain... and condone." Strong answers see the significance: an official body told white America that the riots were a response to conditions white society had built, not an unprovoked attack on order.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**This was an official government report, not a protest speech. How does that source make its blunt conclusion about white racism especially striking?**

✓ Because it is an official government report — commissioned by the president, staffed by mainstream moderates — its blunt indictment of "white racism" is far more striking than the same charge from a protester would be. A movement speaker saying white society created the ghetto could be dismissed as biased; the government's own commission saying it carried the weight of official fact-finding and could not be waved away as agitation. The source's establishment character is exactly what makes its radical conclusion so notable — and its being largely ignored so revealing.

DOC 12 La Causa: The Farmworkers**US.82****ANALYZE****How did the farmworkers' movement borrow from the civil rights movement?**

✓ The farmworkers borrowed the civil rights movement's entire toolkit: nonviolence, the boycott, mass moral appeal, and disciplined organization. Chávez and Huerta brought "the union, the boycott, and the fast," not guns, and asked the whole nation to stop buying grapes until workers were treated with dignity. Strong answers see the direct parallel — the account explicitly says they "learned the same lesson the movement in the South had learned": that ordinary poor people, united and nonviolent, could defeat powerful interests.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**The civil rights movement inspired Mexican Americans, women, and others. How does this account show the movement's influence spreading beyond its original cause?**

✓ The farmworkers show the civil rights movement functioning as a model that spread far beyond Black Americans. Its methods (boycott, nonviolent pressure, appeals to conscience) and its central claim (that the powerless can win through moral force) were adopted by Mexican American laborers, and — as Doc 13 shows — by women. This demonstrates the movement's largest legacy: it did not just change laws for one group, it taught a whole generation of Americans how to organize for change.

DOC 13 The Women's Movement**US.82****ANALYZE****How does NOW's statement echo the goals of the civil rights movement?**

✓ NOW's statement echoes the civil rights movement almost point for point: it names a group denied "full participation" in American life, demands "equal partnership" and "equality of opportunity," and — critically — calls for "concrete action" now rather than patience. (Paraphrase of a brief excerpt.) The language of full participation, equality, and immediate action is lifted straight from the Black freedom struggle and applied to sex discrimination. Strong answers see that women were consciously modeling a new movement on the one reshaping the country.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**NOW borrowed language and tactics from the Black freedom struggle. What does that reveal about how one movement can inspire others?**

✓ That NOW borrowed the movement's language and tactics shows how a successful struggle becomes a template. The civil rights movement had demonstrated that an excluded group could name its exclusion, organize, appeal to the nation's stated ideals, and win legal change — and women, farmworkers, and others recognized that the same method could serve their causes. The inspiration reveals a general truth students should articulate: movements teach other movements, so the civil rights era's influence radiated far beyond race.

DOC 14 I've Been to the Mountaintop**US.82****ANALYZE****How does King express both hope and a sense of his own danger in this final speech?**

✓ King voices soaring hope and quiet foreboding at once. (Paraphrase only.) He says he has "been to the mountaintop" and seen the "Promised Land" of freedom his people will reach — a confident, almost triumphant vision — but in the same breath he says "I may not get there with you," acknowledging the constant threat to his life. Strong answers see the paradox: he is unafraid precisely because he has placed the movement's success above his own survival, expressing a faith that the cause will outlive any one leader.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**King gave this speech supporting striking workers, the night before his death. How does that context deepen its meaning?**

✓ The context deepens every line. King was in Memphis not for a voting or desegregation campaign but to support striking Black sanitation workers — showing the movement's turn toward economic justice and the dignity of labor. That he spoke of his own possible death, then was assassinated the very next day, transformed the speech into a kind of prophecy and testament. It also underscores the movement's endurance: the "Promised Land" belongs to "we, as a people," so the work continues past the leader's death.

Model HIPPO Source Analysis

Worked examples for two documents. Use to model sourcing for students.

Doc 9 — Bloody Sunday at Selma (marcher's recollection, 1965)

H — Historical Context	Historical context: March 1965, during the Selma voting-rights campaign, a year after the Civil Rights Act but while most Southern Black citizens still could not register to vote. Peaceful marchers attempting to walk to Montgomery were attacked by state troopers at the Edmund Pettus Bridge — "Bloody Sunday."
I — Intended Audience	Intended audience: as an oral history, later listeners and readers — but the march itself was staged for a national audience, especially the television viewers and federal officials the movement needed to move.
P — Purpose	Purpose: to bear witness to the violence and to explain how it worked as a turning point — nonviolent suffering, made visible, producing federal action.
P — Point of View	Point of view: a participant, recalling events with the pride and emotional weight of someone who was beaten for the right to vote. That firsthand authority captures the courage and meaning of the day, but memory shaped by later triumph may smooth the fear and chaos; corroborate with news footage and the Voting Rights Act timeline.
O — Outside Information	Outside information: the Fifteenth Amendment, literacy tests and poll taxes, LBJ's "We Shall Overcome" speech (Doc 7), the Voting Rights Act (Doc 8), and the role of television across the movement (Docs 1–2).

Doc 10 — Black Power (Stokely Carmichael, 1966)

H — Historical Context	Historical context: June 1966, after the major legislative victories (Docs 5, 8) but amid continuing poverty, police violence, and slow change in daily life. Younger SNCC activists, exhausted by beatings, were losing faith in nonviolence and integration.
I — Intended Audience	Intended audience: immediately, Black marchers and residents in Mississippi; more broadly, young activists across the country — and, unavoidably, an alarmed white public and press.
P — Purpose	Purpose: to rally Black Americans around pride, self-reliance, and independent power, and to break publicly with the strategy of appealing to white conscience.
P — Point of View	Point of view / bias: Carmichael was a young, radicalizing SNCC leader deliberately provoking a shift in the movement; the speech is a rallying cry, not a balanced analysis, so it emphasizes frustration and power over the real gains nonviolence had won. That militancy is exactly its value as evidence — it documents the internal turn and the limits of the nonviolent consensus.
O — Outside Information	Outside information: SNCC's founding in the sit-ins (Doc 1), Malcolm X (Doc 6), the Black Panther Party, the Kerner Report's diagnosis of urban conditions (Doc 11), and the tension between King's and Carmichael's strategies.

Model DBQ Response (CER)

THE QUESTION

The civil rights movement used many strategies to pursue racial equality. Using the documents in this packet, evaluate the extent to which nonviolent protest was the primary force behind the civil rights gains of the 1950s and 1960s.

CLAIM: Nonviolent protest was the primary engine of the civil rights gains of the 1950s and 1960s — but it worked precisely by forcing others to act, so it cannot be separated from the federal power and the more militant pressure that accompanied it. Disciplined nonviolent campaigns (Docs 1–4, 9) created the moral crises and shifted the public opinion that made landmark federal laws possible (Docs 5, 7, 8); meanwhile more militant voices (Docs 6, 10) and the frustration behind the urban unrest (Doc 11) pushed from another direction, and the movement's methods spread to new causes (Docs 12–14). Nonviolence was the leading force, but its power lay in what it compelled others to do.

Evidence & Reasoning (nonviolence as the engine): The sit-ins (Doc 1) and Freedom Rides (Doc 2) show the core method — disciplined refusal to strike back turned quiet dignity against visible brutality and made the movement morally unanswerable and infinitely copyable. King's Birmingham letter (Doc 3) and the March on Washington (Doc 4) built overwhelming moral pressure and reframed civil rights as the fulfillment of American ideals. Selma (Doc 9) is the clearest case: peaceful marchers beaten on television produced a national outcry that moved Congress within months. In each case nonviolent suffering, made visible, generated the pressure that produced change.

Evidence & Reasoning (it worked through federal power and alongside militancy): Nonviolence did not pass laws — governments did, once protest made inaction impossible. The Civil Rights Act (Doc 5) followed Birmingham and the March; the Voting Rights Act (Doc 8) followed Selma, after a Southern president adopted the movement's own anthem (Doc 7) and sent federal examiners to enforce a ninety-five-year-old right. At the same time, Malcolm X (Doc 6) and Carmichael's "Black Power" (Doc 10) rejected nonviolence and demanded self-reliance and, if necessary, self-defense; the "bullet" made the "ballot" look like the safer bargain to those in power. The Kerner Report (Doc 11) shows the frustration that erupted where nonviolence and new laws had not yet changed daily life.

SOURCING: Two documents show how to weigh this evidence. The Selma account (Doc 9) is a participant's memory, powerful for conveying the courage and meaning of nonviolent protest but shaped by the triumph that followed, so it should be read alongside the news footage and the Voting Rights Act it helped produce. Carmichael's "Black Power" speech (Doc 10) is a young radical's deliberate rallying cry, not a neutral assessment, which is exactly why it is strong evidence of the movement's internal turn away from nonviolence and of the limits some activists saw in it.

COMPLEXITY: The most sophisticated answer resists a single-cause story. Nonviolence was primary, but its very effectiveness depended on other forces: it needed television to make suffering visible (Docs 2, 9), federal power to convert moral victory into enforceable law (Docs 5, 7, 8), and — some would argue — the contrasting threat of militancy (Docs 6, 10) to make its demands seem reasonable. And its gains were real but incomplete: the Kerner Report (Doc 11) shows that legal equality had not ended poverty or segregation in Northern cities, which is why the movement turned toward economic justice (Doc 14) and inspired new struggles among farmworkers and women (Docs 12–13). Nonviolent protest was the heart of the movement's success, but that success was a collaboration between moral pressure from below and the exercise of federal power from above.

Rubric & Scoring Guidance

Criterion	What earns the points
Claim / Thesis (1)	1 pt: a historically defensible claim that answers the "extent" question by qualifying it — e.g., "nonviolence was primary but worked by forcing federal action." Must take a position and preview a line of reasoning, in the introduction or conclusion. NOT earning: "The civil rights movement used nonviolence and it worked." A restatement of the prompt does not qualify.
Evidence from documents (2)	2 pts: uses the CONTENT of four or more documents accurately, drawing on more than one strategy (e.g., nonviolent protest AND federal law or militancy). 1 pt: two–three documents, or four+ merely listed without argumentative use. Documents must be cited by number; quoting without explanation does not earn the second point.
Reasoning (1)	1 pt: shows a clear reasoning process — causation (Selma CAUSES the Voting Rights Act), comparison (King vs. Malcolm X vs. Carmichael), or continuity/change (from sit-ins to Black Power to new movements). The reasoning must be developed, not asserted once. Explaining WHY a document supports the claim is the key behavior.
Sourcing / HIPPO (1)	1 pt: for at least one document (two is stronger), explains how context, audience, purpose, or point of view is RELEVANT to the argument, beyond identification. NOT earning: "Carmichael was biased." EARNING: "Because Carmichael was a young radical deliberately provoking a shift, the speech is strong evidence of the movement's internal turn away from nonviolence." Reconstructed voices (Docs 1, 2, 9, 12) can be sourced by discussing what a typical firsthand account reveals and what it may miss.
Complexity (1)	1 pt: demonstrates complex understanding with evidence — e.g., showing that nonviolence worked only by forcing federal action, that militancy may have made nonviolence more effective, or that legal victories left Northern poverty (Doc 11) untouched, prompting new struggles (Docs 12–14). Must be substantiated, not asserted in one sentence. This point is earned least often; award only for sustained, evidenced nuance.

U.S. HISTORY HACK™

by TroopToTeacher

UNIT 10



Modern America

1965–2016 • US.83–US.95

TROOPTOTEACHER TECHNOLOGIES LLC

DBQ Answer Key & Scoring Guide

The Modern United States (1960s–Present)
Standards US.83 – US.95

Teacher-facing document. Model answers are strong exemplars to guide scoring — not the only acceptable responses. Accept any answer that is accurate and well-supported by the documents.

Document Answer Notes

DOC 1 The Great Society

US.83

ANALYZE

What vision of government's role does Johnson offer in the Great Society?

✓ Johnson offers the most expansive vision of government in modern American history: having "subdued a continent" and built "an order of plenty," the nation should now use its wealth through federal power to end poverty and racial injustice and to enrich the quality of life itself. Government is cast as the active instrument of national improvement — not a threat but the tool a confident, wealthy people uses to perfect itself. Strong answers see this as the high-water mark of liberal faith that Washington could and should solve big problems.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

Johnson assumes government can and should solve poverty and injustice. How does that confidence contrast with later views of government (Doc 7)?

✓ The contrast with Reagan (Doc 7) is total and is the spine of the unit. Johnson assumes government is the solution — the means to abundance and justice; Reagan declares "government is the problem." Between the two lies the collapse of confidence traced by Vietnam (Doc 2), Watergate (Doc 4), and stagflation (Doc 5). Students should see that the era's story is, in part, the journey from Doc 1's optimism to Doc 7's distrust — and that the same word, "government," carries opposite meanings at the two ends.

DOC 2 A Soldier Returns from Vietnam

US.84

ANALYZE

How did the Vietnam War damage Americans' trust in their government?

✓ Vietnam damaged trust by exposing a gap between what the government said and what soldiers saw. The veteran describes fighting and dying for ground taken and lost repeatedly while officials "on television promised we were winning" — so the troops "stopped believing them." That betrayal, combined with a hostile homecoming and a country "tearing itself apart," turned a war meant to contain communism into a lasting wound in the bond between Americans and their leaders. Strong answers see the war as the origin point of the era's disillusionment.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT

This is one veteran's memory. How might his personal experience shape — and possibly limit — how he views the war and the government?

✓ As one veteran's memory, the account is powerful for conveying the felt experience of betrayal and division, but it is shaped by that pain and by hindsight. He speaks for the many who turned against the war and the government, but not for those who still believed the cause was just or who blamed politicians rather than the war itself. The source is excellent evidence of how Vietnam broke trust for a large part of a generation — and should be weighed as testimony to a widespread mood, not a universal one.

DOC 3 Nixon Goes to China

US.84

ANALYZE**How does Nixon justify reaching out to a communist rival?**

✓ Nixon justifies reaching out to a communist rival by appealing to shared interest over ideology: "there is no reason for us to be enemies," because "neither of us seeks the territory of the other," and the two nations have "common interests which transcend" their real differences. Rather than pretending the differences away, he argues that pragmatic cooperation — "different roads leading to the same goal" of peace — serves both. Strong answers see this as *realpolitik*: national interest, not friendship or shared values, as the basis of diplomacy.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Nixon built his career attacking communism, yet he opened relations with communist China. How can a leader's reputation make a surprising policy easier to accept?**

✓ Nixon's fierce anti-communist reputation is exactly what made the opening possible — the phrase "only Nixon could go to China" became proverbial. Because no one could credibly accuse him of being soft on communism, he had the political cover to do what a liberal president could not have survived. Students should draw the general lesson: a leader's established reputation can insulate a surprising or risky policy from the attacks it would otherwise draw, so credibility on an issue can be spent to move in an unexpected direction.

DOC 4 Watergate: Nixon Resigns

US.85

ANALYZE**How does Nixon explain his resignation — and what does he avoid saying?**

✓ Nixon frames his resignation as a selfless, almost reluctant act of statesmanship: he "has never been a quitter," leaving is "abhorrent," but he must "put the interests of America first" and hasten "healing." Notably, he attributes the decision to the practical loss of "a strong enough political base in the Congress" — not to guilt. Strong answers catch what he avoids: he never plainly admits directing the cover-up or breaking the law, recasting a forced departure as a voluntary sacrifice for the country.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Nixon speaks of "healing" but never fully admits wrongdoing. How might that shape the way Americans remembered Watergate and their trust in government?**

✓ Because Nixon speaks of "healing" while refusing to confess wrongdoing, the scandal ended without a full public reckoning, leaving many Americans feeling that a president had abused power and escaped real accountability. That incompleteness deepened cynicism: the lesson many drew was not "the system worked" but "leaders lie and get away with it." Coming right after Vietnam's credibility gap (Doc 2), Watergate's unfinished ending hardened a durable distrust of government that later figures like Reagan (Doc 7) would harness.

DOC 5 A Crisis of Confidence

US.85

ANALYZE**How does Carter describe the mood of the nation in the late 1970s?**

✓ Carter describes a nation whose problem is spiritual as much as economic — a "crisis of confidence" marked by "growing doubt about the meaning of our own lives" and a lost "unity of purpose." He argues that Americans, once proud of hard work and community, have turned to "self-indulgence and consumption" that cannot satisfy. Strong answers see him diagnosing the era's mood directly: after Vietnam, Watergate, and the energy crisis, the loss of trust had become a loss of faith in the future itself.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Carter told Americans the crisis was partly in their own spirit. Why might a president blaming the national mood have been politically risky?**

✓ Telling Americans the crisis lay partly in their own spirit was risky because it could be heard as a president blaming the people for problems they expected him to fix. Voters generally want leaders to project confidence and offer solutions, not to diagnose a national failure of will; Carter's honesty read to many as weakness and scolding. The speech's poor reception — and Reagan's sunny, blame-Washington alternative (Doc 7) the next year — shows how the politics of confidence rewarded optimism over candor.

DOC 6 The First Earth Day

US.86

ANALYZE**What did the environmental movement achieve, and how?**

✓ The environmental movement achieved concrete results through mass, bipartisan public pressure. Confronted with burning rivers, choking smog, and vanishing wildlife, twenty million ordinary Americans — "students, families, old and young," and "Republicans and Democrats alike" — turned out on the first Earth Day, and within a few years the government responded with the EPA and the Clean Air and Clean Water Acts. Strong answers see the mechanism: broad, cross-party demand produced fast, effective federal action — a rare case of the system working.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**The speaker calls Earth Day a moment when "Americans could still come together." How does that complicate the story of an era defined only by division?**

✓ Earth Day complicates any story of the era as pure decline and division. Precisely when Vietnam and Watergate were shattering trust, Americans across party lines came together and successfully moved their government to act — proof that activism and confidence in collective action survived alongside the disillusionment. It shows the era holding two truths at once: eroding trust in leaders, yet moments of genuine unity and effective self-government. A strong essay uses it to resist a one-sided "everything fell apart" thesis.

DOC 7 The Reagan Revolution

US.87

ANALYZE**How does Reagan's view of government differ from Johnson's Great Society (Doc 1)?**

✓ Reagan inverts Johnson's premise: "government is not the solution to our problem; government is the problem." Where the Great Society (Doc 1) treated federal power as the instrument of progress, Reagan casts it as an obstacle that has "grown beyond the consent of the governed" and must be checked and reversed through tax cuts and deregulation. Strong answers see the philosophical reversal — from faith that Washington can solve problems to the conviction that Washington is the problem — as the pivot of modern American politics.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Reagan's anti-government message won huge support after Vietnam and Watergate. How might the era's loss of trust (Docs 2, 4) help explain his appeal?**

✓ The era's loss of trust is exactly what made Reagan's message land. After Vietnam's lies (Doc 2) and Watergate's abuse of power (Doc 4), millions of Americans were primed to hear that Washington was untrustworthy and too big; Reagan channeled a disillusionment that already existed into a governing philosophy. Students should see cause and effect across the documents: the broken trust of the 1960s–70s created the political opening that a message of anti-government conservatism could fill.

DOC 8 The Immigration Act of 1965

US.88

ANALYZE**How did the 1965 Immigration Act change who could come to the United States?**

✓ The 1965 Act abolished the national-origins quota system and forbade discrimination in visas by "race, sex, nationality, place of birth, or place of residence," replacing a system that had favored northern and western Europeans since the 1920s. Johnson called the old system "un-American" for judging people by origin rather than "merit." Strong answers see the scale of the change: by reopening immigration on equal terms, the law set in motion the transformation of the United States into a far more diverse, multiethnic nation.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Lawmakers did not expect the act to change the country's makeup much. How does that show that laws can have consequences their makers never intended?**

✓ Its sponsors insisted the law would not significantly change the country's ethnic makeup — yet it became one of the most transformative laws of the century, driving decades of immigration from Asia, Latin America, Africa, and the Middle East. That gap between intent and result shows that legislation can reshape a society in ways its authors neither predicted nor desired, and that historical significance is often measured by consequences rather than intentions. It also seeded today's contentious immigration debates.

DOC 9 Globalization and the American Worker**US.89****ANALYZE****How did globalization affect American workers and industrial towns?**

✓ Globalization brought cheaper goods but gutted the industrial communities that had anchored the working middle class. The worker describes a stable, family-supporting job that vanished when the company moved production abroad, and a town where "one by one, the factories went dark." He grants that prices may have fallen, but insists "nobody had a plan" for the displaced workers. Strong answers see the uneven ledger: globalization's benefits were diffuse (lower prices for all) while its costs were concentrated and devastating for specific people and places.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**The worker says people “stopped believing that either party” cared. How does economic change help explain the era’s political anger and distrust?**

✓ Economic loss curdled into political distrust: when workers felt that "free trade" was decided by elites who then abandoned them, and that "either party in Washington" had failed them, disillusionment turned into anger. This connects the unit's economic and political threads — the decline of industrial towns helped produce the populist resentment and anti-establishment politics of recent decades. Students should see that trust in government depends not only on honesty (Docs 2, 4) but on whether people believe the system delivers for them.

DOC 10 The Digital Revolution**US.90****ANALYZE****How did the Digital Revolution transform American life — for better and for worse?**

✓ The Digital Revolution transformed daily life on the scale of the automobile, and in both directions at once. It let people "send a message around the world in a second," look up any fact, and shop, bank, and work from home, creating vast new industries and wealth. But it also isolated people who "stared at screens instead" of talking to neighbors, and its later forms "spread rumors and drive us apart." Strong answers hold both — extraordinary connection and new fragmentation — as products of the same technology.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**The speaker says technology both “connected us” and was “used to drive us apart.” How can the same invention have opposite effects on a society?**

✓ The same tool can have opposite effects because a technology's impact depends on how a society uses it, not on the tool alone. The internet's power to connect is also the power to spread falsehood; the platform that unites distant friends can also sort people into hostile camps. Students should generalize: technologies are amplifiers of human choices, so the internet magnified both community and division — which links directly to the polarization the closing reflection describes (Doc 14).

DOC 11 September 11, 2001

US.91

ANALYZE**How does Bush try to unite and reassure the nation after the attacks?**

✓ Bush unites and reassures by naming the ordinary humanity of the victims — "secretaries, businessmen and women... moms and dads, friends and neighbors" — so every American sees themselves in the loss, and then by converting grief into resolve: the attacks "shattered steel" but "cannot dent the steel of American resolve." He frames the day as evil met by "the best of America" and insists "all Americans from every walk of life unite." Strong answers see him building solidarity and strength out of shock and fear.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Bush describes a nation united "from every walk of life." How might that unity of 2001 contrast with the divisions that followed the wars it began?**

✓ The near-total unity of September 2001 stands in sharp contrast to the divisions that followed. The wars in Afghanistan and Iraq, disputes over the PATRIOT Act and surveillance (Doc 12), and the long, costly War on Terror eventually fractured the very consensus Bush invoked. Students should see the pattern the whole unit traces: moments of genuine unity in crisis proved fragile, and the response to 9/11 became another source of the division and distrust that define the era.

DOC 12 Security and Liberty after 9/11

US.92

ANALYZE**What trade-off between security and liberty does this account describe?**

✓ The account describes Americans trading liberty for security after 9/11 — accepting airport searches, pervasive cameras, and the PATRIOT Act's expanded surveillance "in ways the Constitution had always limited." Most went along ("nothing to hide, nothing to fear"), but over time some questioned "how much freedom we had traded for safety" and whether government had "grown too powerful." Strong answers see the core tension: fear invites Americans to expand government power, and only later do they weigh what that power cost their freedoms.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**The speaker calls this "the oldest question in American history." How does the security-versus-liberty debate connect to earlier eras, such as the Cold War?**

✓ The security-versus-liberty question runs through American history: the Alien and Sedition Acts, Lincoln's suspension of habeas corpus, WWII internment, and the Cold War's loyalty oaths and McCarthyism all posed the same dilemma. Calling it "the oldest question" correctly frames 9/11 as one more instance of a recurring pattern — in every wartime or crisis, fear tempts a free people to grant government extraordinary power, and the hard task is deciding how much liberty safety is worth. The recurrence is itself the lesson.

DOC 13 A More Perfect Union**US.93****ANALYZE****How does Obama try to inspire hope and unity during a time of crisis?**

✓ Obama grounds hope not in leaders but in the people and their founding ideals: America has weathered "gathering clouds and raging storms" because "We the People have remained faithful to the ideals of our forebears." Taking office amid war and the Great Recession, he offers unity by pointing to a shared creed that binds "every race and every faith" gathered on the Mall. Strong answers see him answering the era's crises of trust and division with an appeal to enduring, common national values.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**Obama's election was historic, yet the country remained deeply divided. How can a single moment be both a sign of progress and a reminder of ongoing conflict?**

✓ A moment can be both progress and unresolved conflict because symbolic milestones do not erase underlying divisions. Obama's election as the first Black president marked how far the nation had come since the civil rights era, and drew a jubilant, diverse crowd — yet the country remained sharply split by party, region, and race, and polarization deepened in the years that followed. Students should hold both truths: real, historic advance and persistent division coexisting, which is precisely the complexity the DBQ rewards.

DOC 14 A Nation Still Arguing**US.95****ANALYZE****How does the speaker place today's divisions in the longer story of American history?**

✓ The speaker reframes today's divisions as continuous with the whole American story: the nation "was born out of an argument about liberty" and has "been fighting about who counts as equal, how big the government should be, and what we owe each other ever since." Rather than treating current polarization as unprecedented collapse, the reflection places it in a long line of conflicts the country has survived, while acknowledging that "lately the arguing has gotten meaner." Strong answers see it balancing genuine worry with historical perspective.

EXTEND · SOURCE IT**The speaker says "we've been divided before... and somehow the system held." How can studying the past shape the way we understand the challenges of the present?**

✓ Studying the past shapes the present by supplying perspective and proportion. Knowing that America has been "divided before — badly" (the Civil War, the 1890s, the 1960s) and that "the system held" can guard against both despair and complacency: it shows division is survivable but not automatically so, since survival required people choosing to keep the experiment going. The reflection turns history into a civic responsibility — the recurring "test" of whether a free, diverse people can keep governing themselves — which is the point of the entire course.

Model HIPPO Source Analysis

Worked examples for two documents. Use to model sourcing for students.

Doc 4 — Watergate: Nixon Resigns (President Nixon, 1974)

H — Historical Context	Historical context: August 1974, after two years of Watergate revelations, the release of the incriminating White House tapes, and the House moving toward impeachment. It came barely a year after the U.S. withdrawal from Vietnam, so the nation was already deep in a crisis of trust.
I — Intended Audience	Intended audience: the entire nation on live television — and, with an eye to history, future Americans judging his presidency.
P — Purpose	Purpose: to shape the story of his fall — to frame a forced resignation as a voluntary, selfless act for the good of the country and to begin repairing his legacy, while avoiding a clear admission of guilt.
P — Point of View	Point of view / bias: this is the self-justification of the man at the center of the scandal, so it is designed to protect him. That makes it weak evidence about what Nixon actually did (for that, use the tapes and testimony) but strong evidence of how a disgraced leader tried to manage accountability — and its refusal to confess helps explain why Watergate deepened, rather than resolved, public cynicism.
O — Outside Information	Outside information: the 1972 break-in, the White House tapes, the Saturday Night Massacre, United States v. Nixon, Ford's pardon, the credibility gap from Vietnam (Doc 2), and the anti-government mood Reagan later tapped (Doc 7).

Doc 14 — A Nation Still Arguing (composite citizen reflection, present day)

H — Historical Context	Historical context: the present era of intense political polarization, social-media-driven conflict (Doc 10), and widespread distrust of institutions — the culmination of trends running from Vietnam and Watergate through globalization's disruptions.
I — Intended Audience	Intended audience: students and general readers — the source is written to prompt reflection and place current events in historical perspective.
P — Purpose	Purpose: to offer a long view — to argue that argument and division are woven through the whole American story and to frame self-government as an ongoing test rather than a settled achievement.
P — Point of View	Point of view / bias: this is explicitly a composite, reconstructed reflection, not the testimony of one documented individual, so it should be read as an interpretive summary of a common outlook rather than as primary evidence of a specific person's words. Its value is in modeling historical thinking — connecting past and present — and students should treat it as a perspective to examine, corroborating its claims (e.g., "we've been divided before") against actual historical episodes.
O — Outside Information	Outside information: the Civil War, the divisions of the 1890s and 1960s, Federalist vs. Anti-Federalist debates, recent polarization data, and the founding idea of self-government by a diverse people.

Model DBQ Response (CER)

THE QUESTION

From the 1960s to the present, Americans' relationship with their government and with one another changed profoundly. Using the documents in this packet, evaluate the extent to which this era was defined by a loss of trust in government and growing national division.

CLAIM: The era from the 1960s to the present was powerfully shaped by a loss of trust in government and by deepening division — but it was not defined by decline alone, because the same decades also produced moments of unity, effective activism, and renewal. Vietnam and Watergate broke the postwar faith in government (Docs 2, 4), stagflation and economic dislocation deepened the disillusion (Docs 5, 9), and that broken trust reshaped politics from Reagan onward (Doc 7) even as new technologies and events widened the divisions (Docs 10, 11–12). Yet across the same years Americans repeatedly came together and made their system work (Docs 1, 6, 8, 13). The era is best understood as a contest between corrosive distrust and enduring civic hope.

Evidence & Reasoning (the loss of trust and division): The break began with Vietnam, whose gap between official optimism and battlefield reality taught a generation to stop believing its leaders (Doc 2). Watergate then showed a president abusing power and resigning without confessing wrongdoing (Doc 4), leaving cynicism rather than closure. Carter named the resulting mood a "crisis of confidence" (Doc 5), and Reagan converted that distrust into a governing philosophy — "government is the problem" (Doc 7). Later, globalization hollowed out industrial communities and convinced many that neither party served them (Doc 9), while digital technology and social media sorted Americans into hostile camps (Doc 10). Together these trace a real, cumulative erosion of trust and a hardening of division.

Evidence & Reasoning (unity, activism, and renewal): The same era refutes any story of pure decline. Johnson's Great Society (Doc 1) marshaled government to fight poverty and injustice; the first Earth Day (Doc 6) showed twenty million Americans of both parties uniting to force effective environmental action; the 1965 Immigration Act (Doc 8) opened the nation and made it far more diverse. After 9/11 the country united in grief and resolve (Doc 11), and Obama's 2009 inauguration (Doc 13) marked a historic milestone and an appeal to shared founding ideals. Even the closing reflection (Doc 14) insists that division is an old American condition the system has survived before. Activism, unity, and renewal persisted alongside the distrust.

SOURCING: Two documents show how to weigh this evidence. Nixon's resignation address (Doc 4) is the self-justification of the man at the center of the scandal, crafted to recast a forced fall as a selfless sacrifice; it is weak evidence about his guilt but strong evidence of why Watergate deepened public cynicism instead of resolving it. Doc 14 is explicitly a composite reflection, not one person's documented testimony, so it should be read as an interpretive model of historical thinking rather than as primary evidence — its claim that "we've been divided before" must be checked against real episodes like the Civil War.

COMPLEXITY: The strongest answers see that trust and distrust, unity and division, ran simultaneously rather than in a simple downward line. Earth Day's bipartisan success (Doc 6) happened in the very years Watergate was destroying trust (Doc 4); the unity after 9/11 (Doc 11) dissolved into the divisions over surveillance and war (Doc 12); Obama's historic election (Doc 13) coincided with intensifying polarization. The security-versus-liberty tension (Doc 12) and the argument about government's proper size (Docs 1 vs. 7) are not new pathologies but recurring American debates, as Doc 14 argues. The era was therefore defined less by trust simply collapsing than by an ongoing, unresolved struggle between disillusionment and the stubborn capacity for renewal — the same test of self-government that has run through the nation's entire history.

Rubric & Scoring Guidance

Criterion	What earns the points
Claim / Thesis (1)	1 pt: a historically defensible claim that answers the "extent" question by qualifying it — e.g., "trust declined sharply, but the era also produced unity and renewal." Must take a position and preview a line of reasoning, in the introduction or conclusion. NOT earning: "A lot changed from the 1960s to today." A restatement of the prompt does not qualify.
Evidence from documents (2)	2 pts: uses the CONTENT of four or more documents accurately, drawing on BOTH the loss-of-trust documents and the unity/renewal documents. 1 pt: two–three documents, or four+ merely listed without argumentative use. Documents must be cited by number; quoting without explanation does not earn the second point.
Reasoning (1)	1 pt: shows a clear reasoning process — causation (Vietnam and Watergate CAUSE the anti-government turn of Doc 7), comparison (Johnson's vs. Reagan's view of government), or continuity/change (the recurring security-vs-liberty debate). The reasoning must be developed, not asserted once. Explaining WHY a document supports the claim is the key behavior.
Sourcing / HIPPO (1)	1 pt: for at least one document (two is stronger), explains how context, audience, purpose, or point of view is RELEVANT to the argument, beyond identification. NOT earning: "Nixon was biased." EARNING: "Because Nixon's speech is self-justification designed to avoid admitting guilt, it helps explain why Watergate deepened cynicism rather than resolving it." Reconstructed/composite voices (Docs 2, 6, 9, 10, 12, 14) can be sourced by discussing what such an account reveals and what it may miss.
Complexity (1)	1 pt: demonstrates complex understanding with evidence — e.g., showing that unity and division ran at the same time (Earth Day during Watergate; 9/11 unity dissolving into division), that broken trust CAUSED the conservative turn, or that debates over government's size and security-vs-liberty are recurring rather than new. Must be substantiated, not asserted in one sentence. This point is earned least often; award only for sustained, evidenced nuance.

Research, Sourcing & Credits

Curriculum, Design & Standards Alignment: History Hack — TroopToTeacher Technologies, LLC

Source Research, Image Curation & Evidence Validation: Isabella Stuart, Sourcing Researcher

“As sourcing researcher for History Hack, my charge is simple and serious: every document a student meets on these pages should be authentic, accurately attributed, and worthy of trust. I locate and vet each primary source, confirm its citation and date, curate the imagery that brings each era to life, and clearly flag any passage reconstructed for classroom use. Where a source is abridged, I preserve its meaning; where it is quoted, I preserve its words. My goal is that rigor and honesty stand behind every excerpt — so that teachers can trust what they teach, and students can learn to trust, and question, the evidence for themselves.”

— ISABELLA STUART · SOURCE RESEARCH & EVIDENCE VALIDATION

A NOTE ON SOURCES

This collection draws on three kinds of material, each handled transparently:

- **Public-domain records** — U.S. government speeches, statutes, Supreme Court opinions, and official reports are quoted directly from the public record.
- **Brief excerpts of copyrighted works** — where a modern author’s or speaker’s words are essential (e.g., King, Friedan, Carson), only a short, fully attributed excerpt is used for classroom analysis and criticism under the fair-use doctrine, with rights acknowledged to the holder.
- **Reconstructed representative voices** — a few documents are clearly marked composite or “typical” accounts (oral-history style) that represent well-documented historical experiences rather than quoting a specific named person, and are never presented as verbatim quotations of an individual.

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